Thomas Chick

Submission: Joint Standing Committee on Electoral Matters inquiry into the conduct of the 2025 federal election and other matters

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Preface: The author of this submission is not qualified to make it

I did not go to university. I have no qualifications in nor have I formally studied statistics or political science. Honestly, I barely scraped through my mandatory education. All of this is okay.

It's okay, because what I *do* have is a fascination with electoral systems and the outcomes they produce, and the self-taught ability to put those outcomes into visual form by way of charts and tables.

It's okay, because what I *do* have are opinions on the state of those systems and the ways they can be improved or adjusted, and through the power of technology, the means to put those opinions into words.

It's okay, because what I *do* have is the prior work of the psephological giants whose shoulders I stand on: Ben Raue of The Tally Room, William Bowe of The Poll Bludger, the ABC's successive chief election analysts, Antony Green and Casey Briggs, and fellow Tasmanian Dr Kevin Bonham, without all of whom I would know considerably less than I do now.

It's okay, because what I *do* have is over twenty-six years of life in Australia, a land where we hold inquiries into our largest and most important institutions, that anyone can speak to, even when on the whole there isn't too much to complain about, because that is the correct and fair thing to do.

And *that* is more than okay.

Thomas Chick [he/they]
City of Clarence, Lutruwita / Tasmania
Division of Franklin
13 November 2025

P.S. I am open to appearing in front of the committee should they so require. I don't do mornings.

This submission is typeset in Newsreader,
with headings in Roboto Flex.
The charts are rendered with Observable Plot.
The tables are generated using the Python library Dominate.
The PDF as a whole is rendered from an HTML file with Vivliostyle.

Abbreviated terms

Abbreviation	Meaning
ABC	Australian Broadcasting Corporation
ABS	Australian Bureau of Statistics
AEC	Australian Electoral Commission
CEA	*Commonwealth Electoral Act 1918*
the Constitution	*Commonwealth of Australia Constitution Act 1900* (Imp), s9
ERP	Estimated Resident Population
JSCEM	Joint Standing Committee on Electoral Matters
UK	United Kingdom
ACT	Australian Capital Territory
NSW	New South Wales
NT	Northern Territory
Qld.	Queensland
SA	South Australia
Tas.	Tasmania
Vic.	Victoria
WA	Western Australia

List of recommendations

House formality and savings provisions

That the *Commonwealth Electoral Act 1918* be amended:

1. So that a ballot paper in a House of Representatives election is not informal as long as it indicates an order of preference for at least six candidates;
2. So that a formal ballot paper in a House of Representatives election can be set aside as exhausted; and
3. Notwithstanding 1 and 2, so that a ballot paper in a House of Representatives election still instructs the voter to number all candidates.

The tide of early voting

That the *Commonwealth Electoral Act 1918* be amended:

1. So that Section 200A no longer imposes any grounds upon an elector applying for a pre-poll vote; and accordingly
2. So that the title of Schedule 2 no longer references pre-poll voting.

Expanding the parliament

1. That the *Representation Act 1983* be repealed and replaced with a Representation Act that has similar effect, except that the number of senators for each State shall be 18;
2. Assuming 1 is not adopted, the same, except that the number of senators for each State shall be 16.

The author of this submission has no opinion on the representation of territories in the Senate, except:

3. That in the event territory representation in the Senate is increased to a number less than 6 total Senators, those Senators continue to be elected for unstaggered terms of three years.

Pipe dream constitutional amendments

1. That someone much smarter than me look into what can *actually* be done about section 44 of the Constitution;
2. That no changes be attempted to sections 7(¶4), 13, 24 or 28 of the Constitution; and
3. That no attempt be made to introduce fixed terms to the House of Representatives.

Miscellaneous thoughts

1. **Do not tarnish the perceived impartiality of the Australian Electoral Commission by saddling them with responsibility for "truth in political advertising" laws.**

House formality and savings provisions

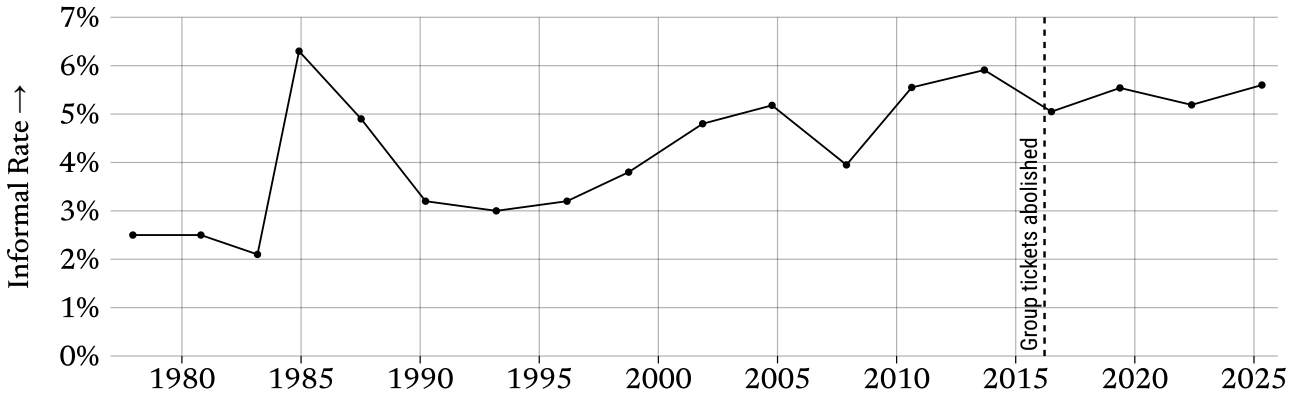

Chart 1: House of Representatives informal voting rates since 1977[1] (see also appendix C)

Informal voting rates in the House of Representatives increased slightly at the 2025 federal election, but remain in the range of 5-6% as they have since 2010. 5.60% is the highest such rate since group voting tickets were abolished prior to the 2016 federal election.

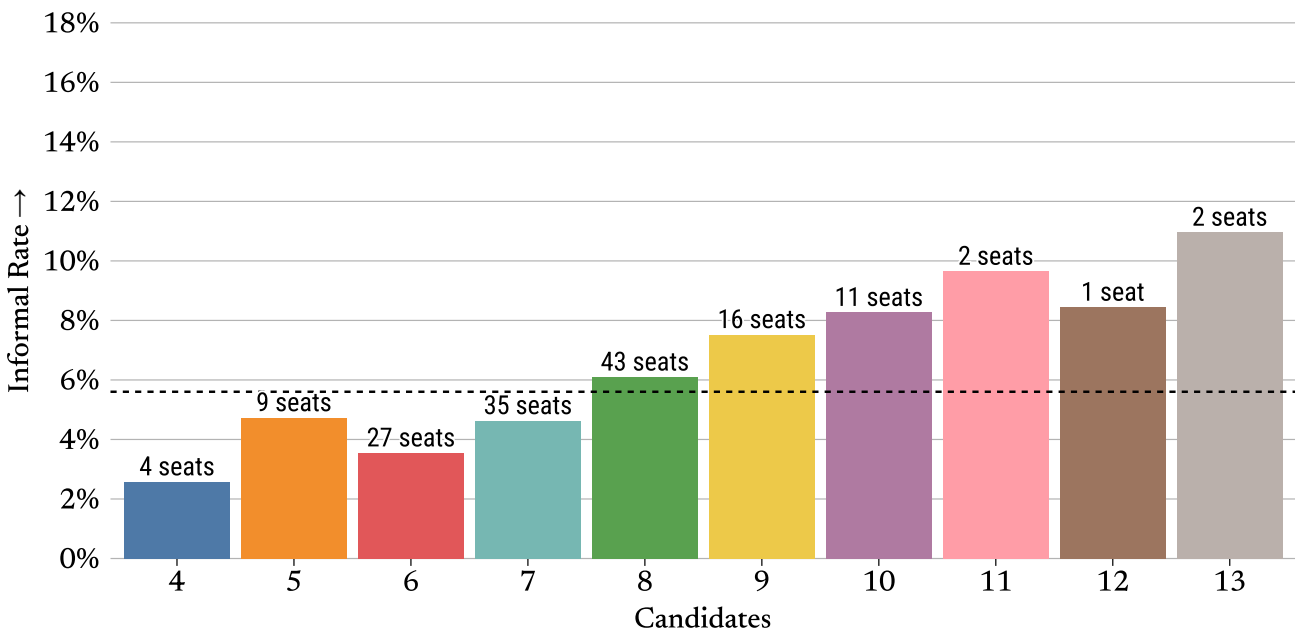

Chart 2: House of Representatives informal voting rates at the 2025 federal election, broken down by candidate count (dashed line is national rate, see also appendices A and B)

Rates continue to be inflated by electoral divisions with higher candidate counts. Informal voting rates noticeably increase in divisions with at least 8 candidates, and roughly trend upwards as candidate counts continue to increase.

[1] https://www.aec.gov.au/voting/informal_voting/summary.htm

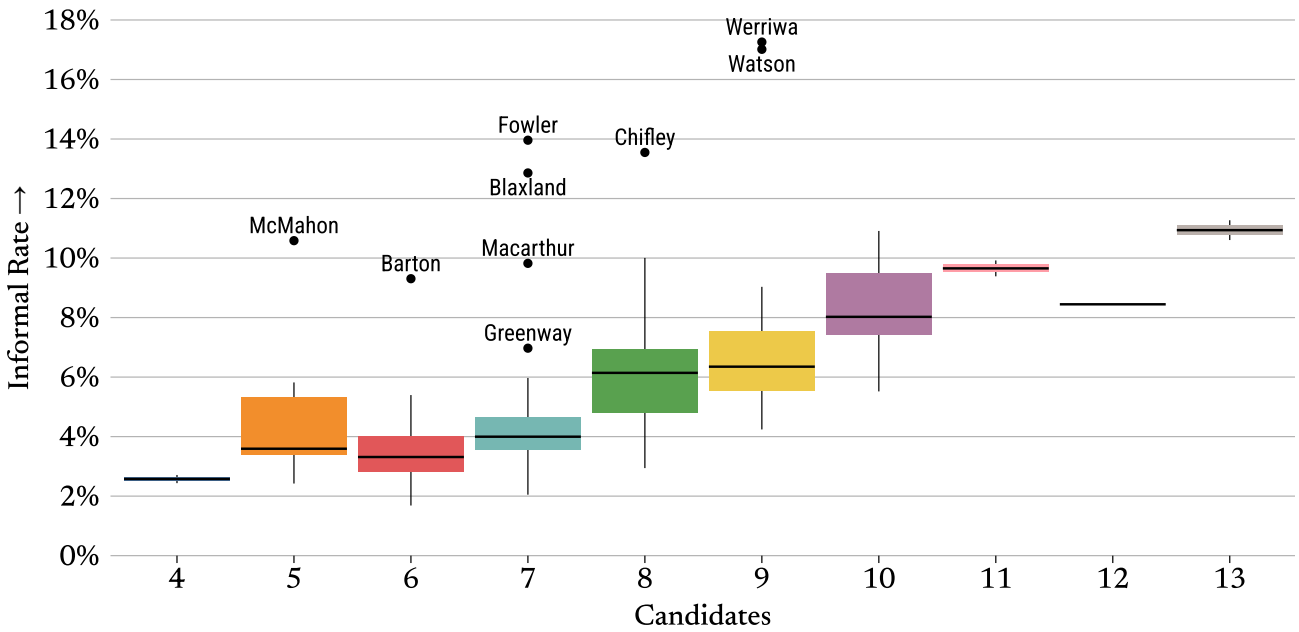

Chart 3: House of Representatives informal voting rates at the 2025 federal election, box plot broken down by candidate count, outliers separated (see also appendices A and B)

National rates aside, rates are particularly high in Inner and Outer Metropolitan divisions in New South Wales, a category which captures all of the outliers in the above chart. The cultural and linguistic reasons for this are discussed by the AEC on their website.[2]

A likely contributing factor to higher informal rates in divisions with at least 8 candidates is confusion with Senate above-the-line voting rules. Section 239(2) of the CEA instructs that when voting above the line for the Senate, the voter must write at least the numbers 1 to 6. Section 240 instructs that when voting for the House of Representatives, the voter must write the numbers 1 to *n*, where *n* is the number of candidates.

The 7 candidate case is caught by s268(1)(c), which provides that House ballots which omit the last number and leave the remaining box entirely unmarked are considered formal.[3] As such, a voter that assumes the rules are the same for both the Senate and House ballots, in spite of printed instructions to the contrary, can record a formal House vote if no more than 7 candidates are on the ballot, but *may* record an informal vote otherwise.

[2] https://www.aec.gov.au/election/fe25/participation-rates.htm, under *Electoral divisions with higher informality*.

[3] There is no functional difference between a 7 candidate ballot marked 1-7 and one marked 1-6, because even if an election requires all but two candidates to be excluded before it can be resolved, a ballot will never be distributed to the voter's last (7th) preference.

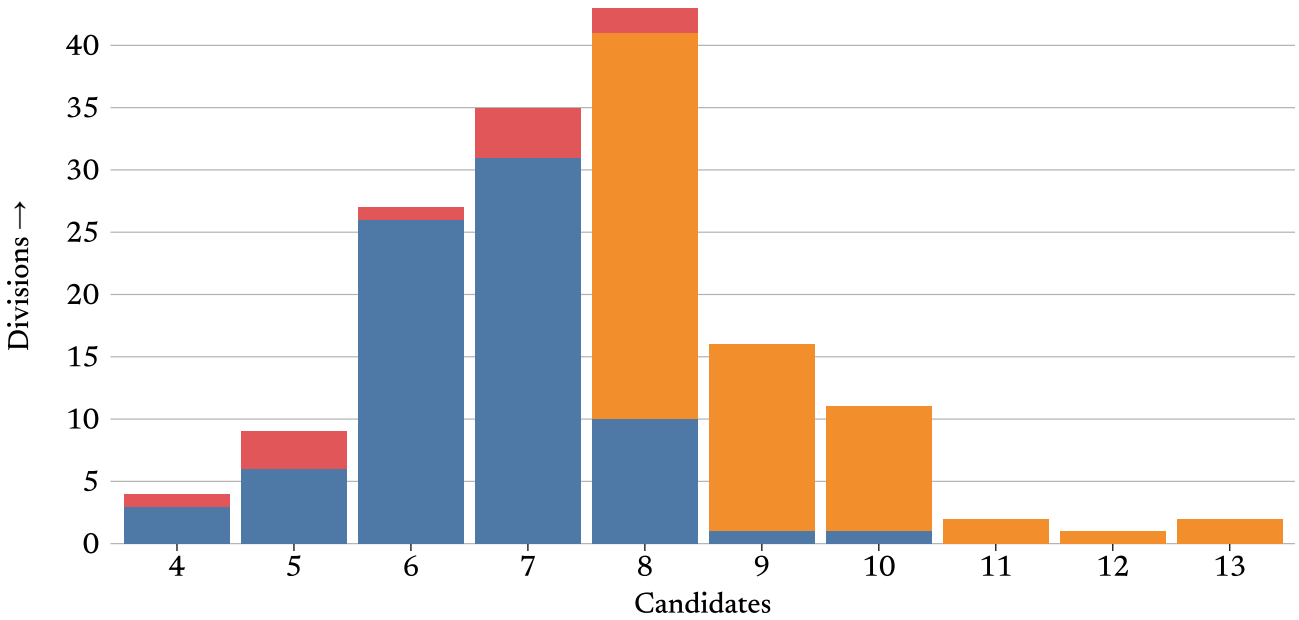

Chart 4: House of Representatives divisions at the 2025 federal election by candidate count

0 exclusions[4] <6 exclusions ≥6 exclusions[5]

75 divisions, exactly half of all divisions, meet the 8+ candidate criterion. Most divisions with 8 candidates required the elimination of at least six candidates to determine a winner, as did almost all divisions with at least 9 candidates.

While I do not desire to move to fully optional preferences[6] for House elections, believing that as many ballots as possible should remain in the count at each stage, I believe that it is still possible to strike a balance that reduces informality without too badly reducing the strength of ballots. As such, I recommend:

Recommendation

That the *Commonwealth Electoral Act 1918* be amended:

1. So that a ballot paper in a House of Representatives election is not informal as long as it indicates an order of preference for at least six candidates;
2. So that a formal ballot paper in a House of Representatives election can be set aside as exhausted; and
3. Notwithstanding 1 and 2, so that a ballot paper in a House of Representatives election still instructs the voter to number all candidates.[7]

[4] In other words, the winner was elected on first preferences.

[5] In other words, the winner was not mathematically certain until at least 6 other candidates had been eliminated.

[6] Which is to say, only a first preference is required, not that voting at all should be non-compulsory.

[7] I suspect certain regular JSCEM participants will consider this dishonest, and disagree vigorously with the very notion that one should lie to the voting public. But my goal is more accessible democracy, and the truth is frankly overrated, so oh well. Pendulums and roundabouts, I suppose. :P

Sidenote: Careful consideration of candidacy cautioned by Chick, T

All that being said, there is perhaps some blame to be laid at the feet of those who nominate for election. While I take it as a sign of a healthy and functioning democracy that so many are willing to throw their respective hats in the ring, the unfortunate truth is that most campaigns are doomed to fail, and many to do so miserably.

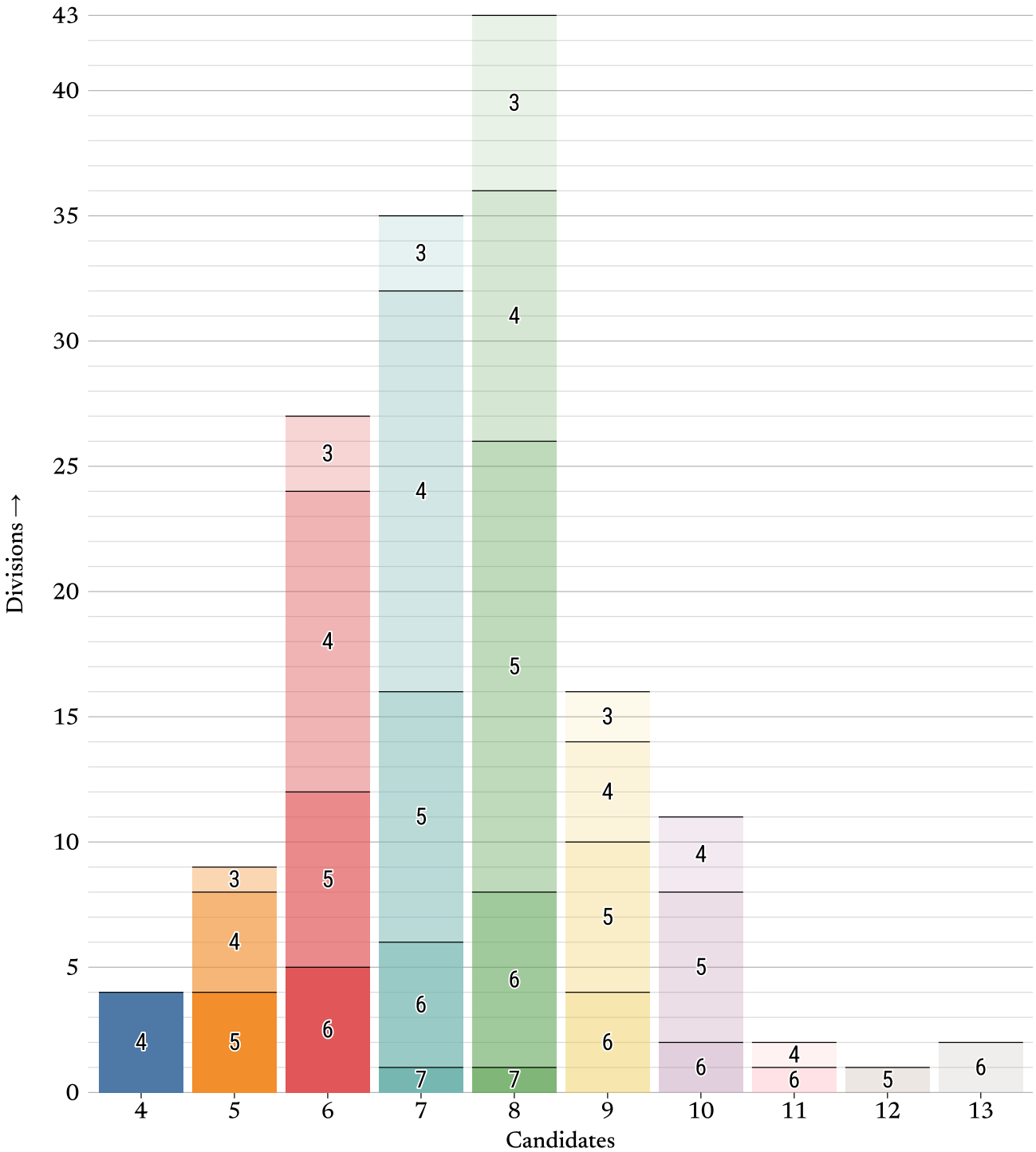

Chart 5: House of Representatives divisions at the 2025 federal election by candidate count
Number labels correspond to number of candidates achieving ≥4% first preferences

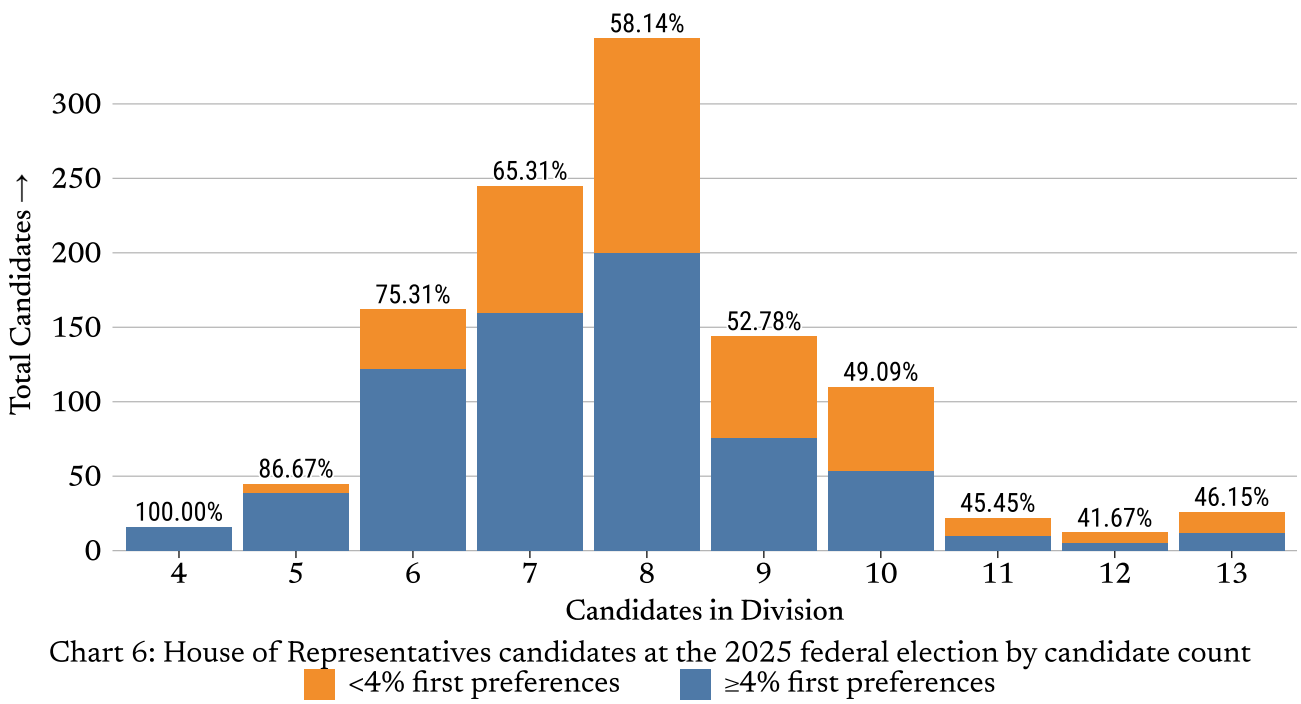

Chart 6: House of Representatives candidates at the 2025 federal election by candidate count

Section 170(2) of the CEA provides that, in order to nominate for election to either house, the intending nominee must place a deposit of $2,000. Section 173 provides that the deposit will be returned if the candidate is elected, or if they (or their group) receive at least 4% of first preferences in the relevant contest.[8]

In House of Representatives contests at the 2025 federal election, 694 of the 1,126 candidates (61.63%) met the 4% threshold. The remaining 432 put a collective $864,000 into the Commonwealth's coffers.[9]

Far be it from me to dictate what people do with their money, but I would suggest that one should probably not throw $2,000 into an effort that has little chance of success and a much greater chance of making things more difficult for voters.

That being said, I do not here propose that any further barriers be placed upon intending candidates at this time.

[8] Section 293 also provides election funding to candidates and groups meeting the 4% threshold, but does not include elected candidates scoring less than 4%.

[9] Which one has to assume almost immediately came back out again to partly pay for election funding under s293.

The tide of early voting

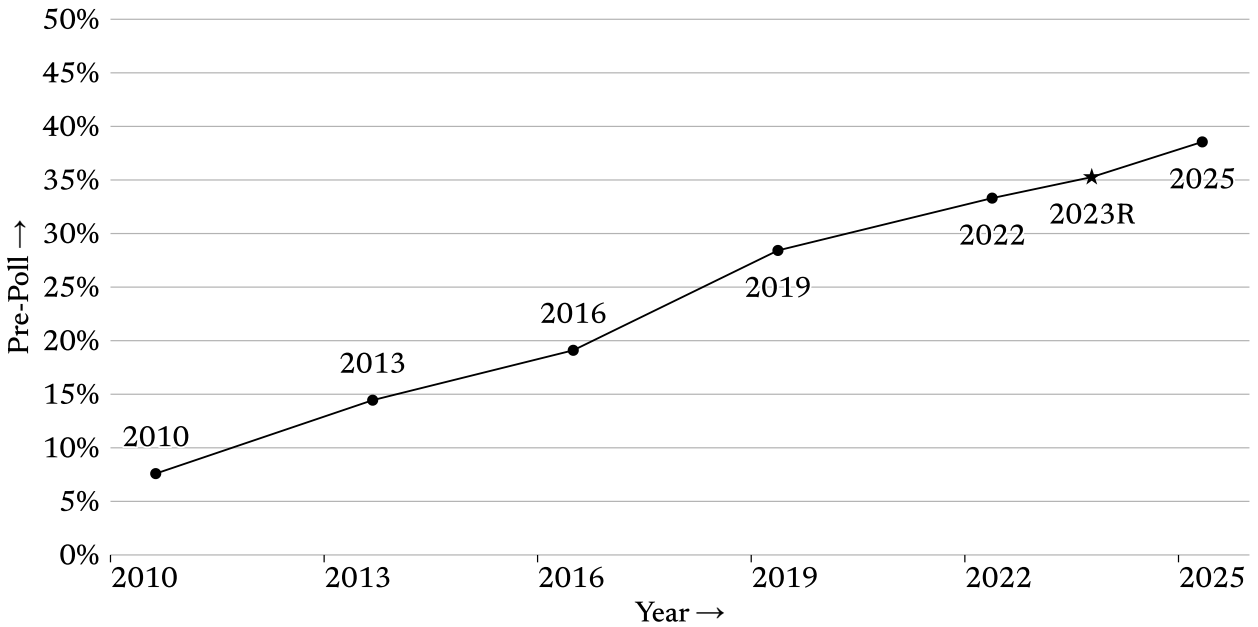

Chart 7: Votes made at pre-poll voting centres as a percentage of all votes made

The *Electoral and Referendum Amendment (Pre-poll Voting and Other Measures) Act 2010*[10] amended the CEA and the *Referendum (Machinery Provisions) Act 1984* to provide that non-declaration pre-poll votes cast in the voter's division were to be considered ordinary votes.

Schedule 2 of the CEA provides a list of grounds under which a voter is eligible to receive a postal or pre-poll vote. The grounds all relate to inability to attend an in-division or in-state polling booth on polling day. The 2010 Act initially required that an intending pre-poll voter sign a certificate declaring their eligibility, but the AEC recommended to the JSCEM following that year's election that the requirement should be removed,[11] which occurred prior to the 2013 election.

Since the implementation of the 2010 Act, the percentage of votes made at pre-poll voting centres has increased essentially linearly. At the 2025 election, 38.55% of all votes were cast at a pre-poll voting centre.

The likelihood that 38.55% of voters are unable to access an in-division or in-state polling booth on polling day, a *Saturday*, seems to me like it should be quite low. Is everyone going off on holiday, or suddenly falling ill, or going to jail? I think not.

The trouble with these eligibility grounds is that there is not, and cannot be, any penalty for ignoring Schedule 2 and voting early anyway. Applying a maximum length of 12 days to the pre-polling period in 2021[12] did nothing to stem the tide.

[10] https://www.legislation.gov.au/C2010A00109/latest/text

[11] Inquiry into the conduct of the 2010 Federal Election and matters related thereto, Submission 87, p79, https://www.aph.gov.au/Parliamentary_Business/Committees/House_of_Representatives_Committees?url=em/elect10/subs/sub087.pdf

[12] *Electoral Legislation Amendment (Counting, Scrutiny and Operational Efficiencies) Act 2021*, https://www.legislation.gov.au/C2021A00092/latest/text

The reality of the situation is that no matter how much politicians want to grumble about polling day becoming a "polling period", a growing cohort of people want to vote early, and do so. The time has come to acknowledge that and act accordingly.

Recommendation

That the *Commonwealth Electoral Act 1918* be amended:

1. So that Section 200A no longer imposes any grounds upon an elector applying for a pre-poll vote; and accordingly
2. So that the title of Schedule 2 no longer references pre-poll voting.

Sidenote: This chart *really* illustrates the trouble

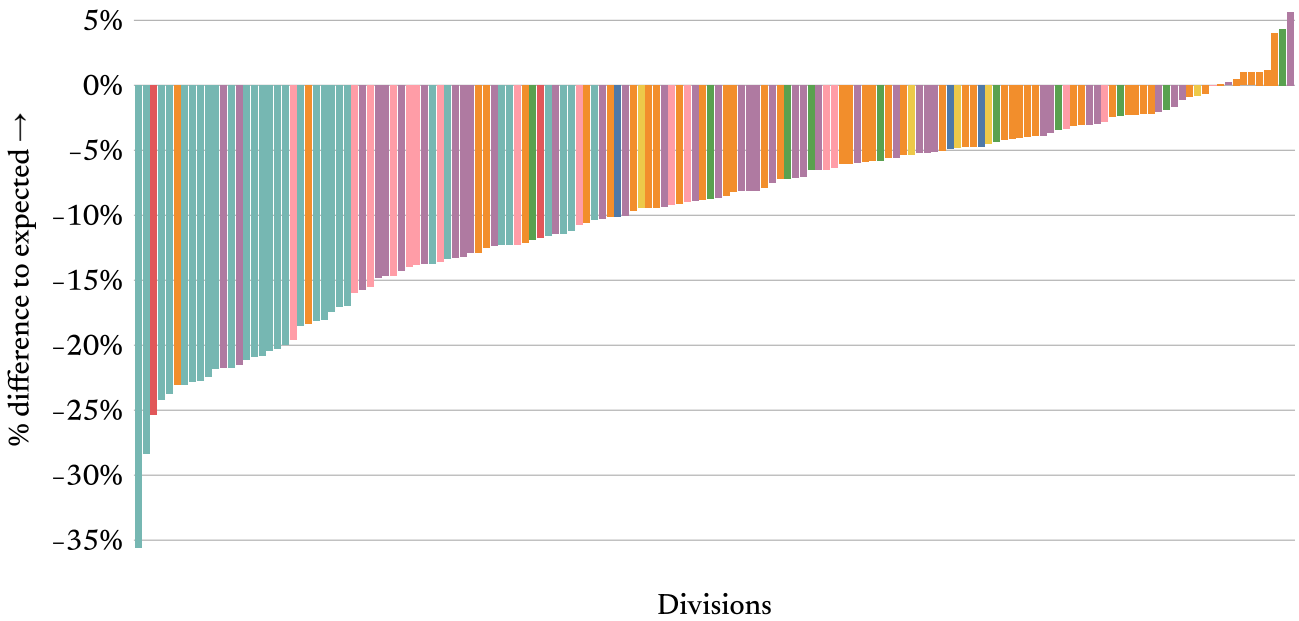

Chart 8: Percentage difference from expected in-division polling day ordinary votes at polling booths, by division (see also appendix D)

The AEC publishes and regularly updates a list of locations they expect will be used as polling places on polling day, specifically noting where a booth has been added or removed from the list. Included in the list are estimates of the number of ordinary and declaration votes expected to be processed on the day, as well as the staffing required to process those amounts.

Those figures make for fascinating reading after the election has actually taken place. The vast majority of booths (and so, divisions) are down on expectations, many significantly so.

At the left end of the chart, clocking in at 35.55% below expected, we have the Division of Dawson in Queensland. Eleven divisions defeated expectations, five by more than 1%.[13]

I'm not proposing reducing on-the-day polling booths, that's just asking for trouble. Overall turnout remains high, all is well. I just thought this chart was neat.

Expanding the parliament

Note

There is an important distinction to be made at this juncture between *people* and *electors*. The Constitution requires, in section 24, that the allocation of House seats to states is calculated based on the number of *people* in those states. How the states are then divided is left as an exercise for the Parliament. The CEA provides that divisions are created based on the positions of *electors* within the states.

Throughout this chapter I will be performing calculations based on numbers of *people*, as I have nothing to say at this time about the precise method of division creation. Members represent all people within the boundaries of their divisions, not just those who can vote.

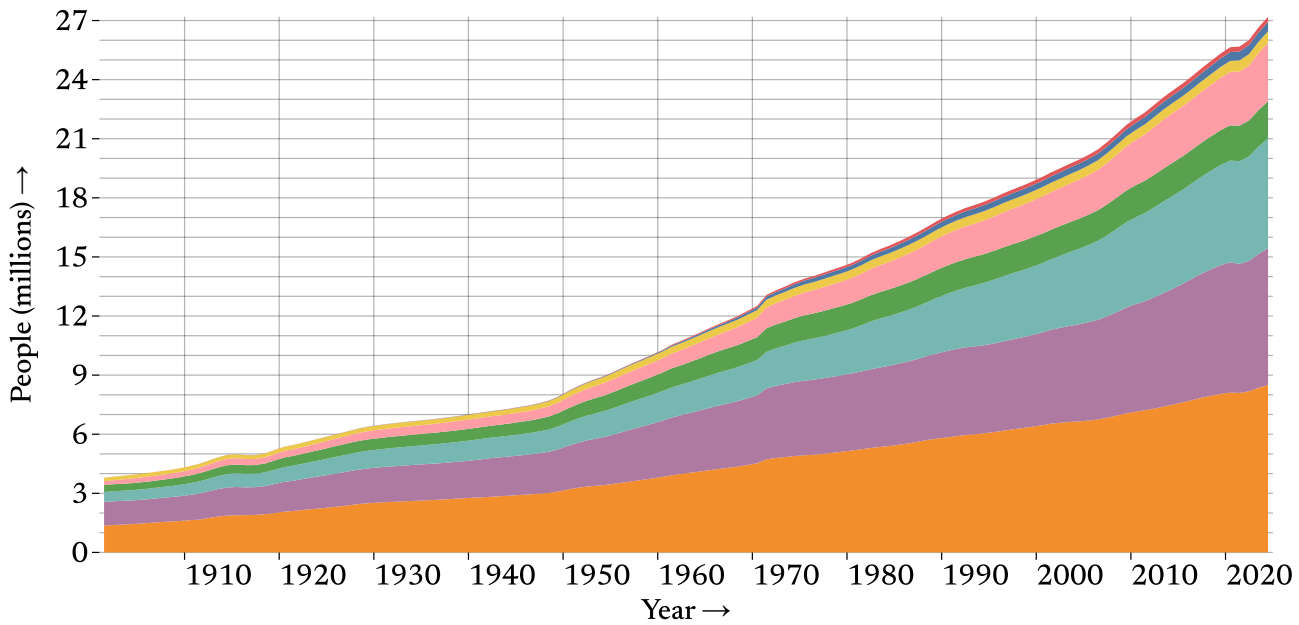

Chart 9: Population of Australian states and territories as at June 30, 1901-2024[14]

NSW Vic. Qld. SA WA Tas. ACT NT

I hope I'm not surprising anyone too badly when I say that Australia is still growing, as it has all but two years since Federation, and by all accounts, it should continue to do so well into the back half of the century.[15]

[13] Hasluck, WA (+0.04%); Mitchell, NSW (+0.13%); Calwell, Vic. (+0.23%); Bennelong, NSW (+0.50%); Sydney, NSW (+0.99%); Berowra, NSW (+1.00%); Eden-Monaro, NSW (+1.04%); Richmond, NSW (+1.21%); Grayndler, NSW (+4.03%); Kingston, SA (+4.33%); Melbourne, VIC (+5.66%)

[14] Data derived from the ABS' Estimated Resident Population for 30 June of each year between 1984 and 2024: https://www.abs.gov.au/statistics/people/population/historical-population/2021; https://www.abs.gov.au/statistics/people/population/national-state-and-territory-population/jun-2024, under *Time series spreadsheets: Population - states and territories*

[15] https://www.abs.gov.au/statistics/people/population/population-projections-australia/latest-release

The Constitution, in section 24, defines the "nexus" between the Senate and the House of Representatives:

24. Constitution of House of Representatives

The House of Representatives shall be composed of members directly chosen by the people of the Commonwealth, and the number of such members shall be, as nearly as practicable, twice the number of the senators.

The number of members chosen in the several States shall be in proportion to the respective numbers of their people, and shall, until the Parliament otherwise provides, be determined, whenever necessary, in the following manner:

i. a quota shall be ascertained by dividing the number of the people of the Commonwealth, as shown by the latest statistics of the Commonwealth, by twice the number of the senators;
ii. the number of members to be chosen in each State shall be determined by dividing the number of the people of the State, as shown by the latest statistics of the Commonwealth, by the quota; and if on such division there is a remainder greater than one-half of the quota, one more member shall be chosen in the State.

But notwithstanding anything in this section, five members at least shall be chosen in each Original State.

Sections 7 and 26 then set out the initial numbers of Senators and Representatives,[16] further requiring that each Original State have the same number of Senators. Section 7 and 27 allow the Parliament to modify the number of members within these parameters. And so, as Australia has grown, Parliament has periodically expanded, first by increasing the number of Senators for each state to 10 before the 1949 election, then to 12 before the 1984 election.

It has now been 41 years since the last expansion of Parliament, and Australia's population has nearly doubled, with no further expansion. The time is very ripe to expand now. But how much?

We can do some maths about that.

[16] Including a fun artifact of the time it wasn't clear whether Western Australia was signing on or not.

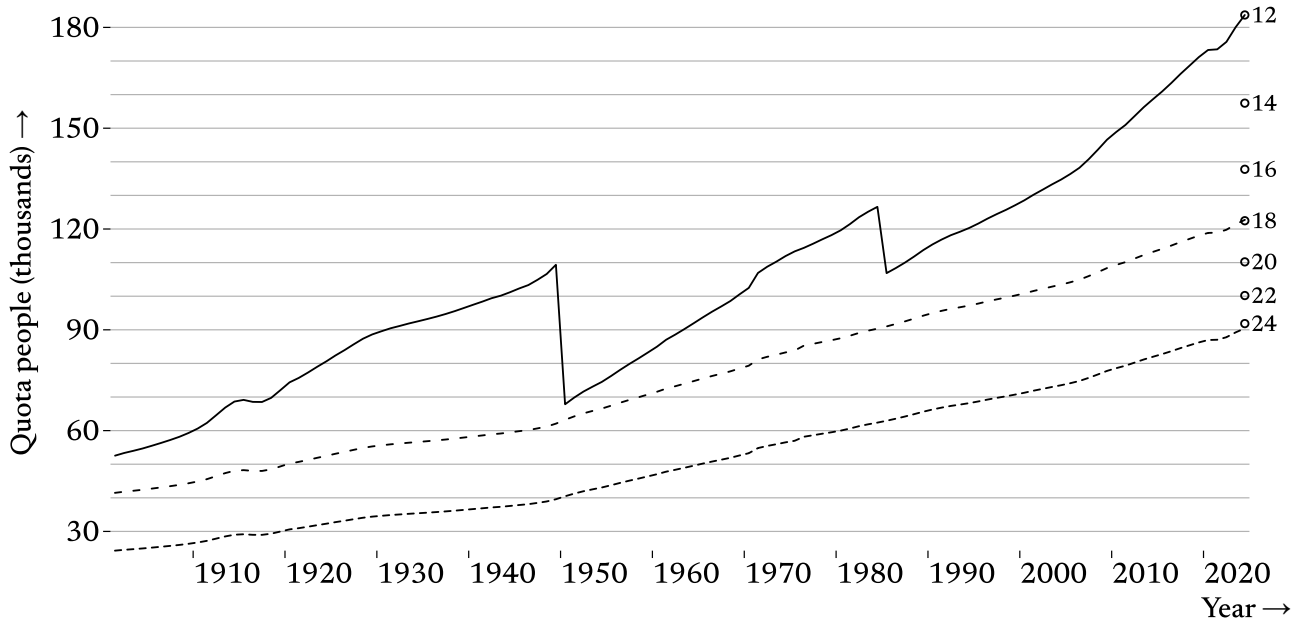

Chart 10: The value of one s24 quota,
if calculated on June 30 of each year, 1901-2024 (see also appendix E)

In 1972,[17] Estonian political scientist Rein Taagepera observed that, *very* roughly, the size of any country's lower or sole legislative house was the cube root of that country's population. We can flip this metric, called the *cube root law*, on its head to compare with the current quota system, by dividing the population by its own cube root. This is the lower dashed line in the above chart. Australia has never come even remotely close to meeting this metric.

49 years later,[18] Swiss-American physicist Giorgio Margaritondo argued that the cube root law was fatally flawed, proposing instead $0.1P^{0.45\pm0.03}$, where P is the population.[19] This metric can be flipped in the same way, resulting in the upper dashed line in the above chart, which definitely feels closer to something workable.

The dots to the right of the chart show the value of one quota, calculated based on hypothetical numbers of Senators for each state. By far the closest to meeting the Margaritondo metric is a move to 18 Senators per state. I have other reasons to recommend 18 specifically, but we will come to those shortly.

Calculating based on what has already come is all well and good, can we make any sort of projection about what comes next? The ABS releases long-term projections for Australia's population[20] every few years, from which we can derive projections for the size of one quota for each of the supplied senator counts.

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[17] Taagepera, R. (1972). The size of national assemblies. *Social Science Research*, 1(4), 385-401. http://dx.doi.org/10.1016/0049-089x(72)90084-1 Retrieved from https://escholarship.org/uc/item/45g370k4

[18] Margaritondo, G. (2021). Size of National Assemblies: The Classic Derivation of the Cube-Root Law is Conceptually Flawed. *Frontiers in Physics*, Vol. 8 2020. https://dx.doi.org/10.3389/fphy.2020.614596 Retrieved from https://www.frontiersin.org/journals/physics/articles/10.3389/fphy.2020.614596

[19] For simplicity's sake, I have chosen to ignore the ±0.03, and also to not put this footnote directly next to an already superscripted piece of text.

[20] https://www.abs.gov.au/statistics/people/population/population-projections-australia/2022-base-2071

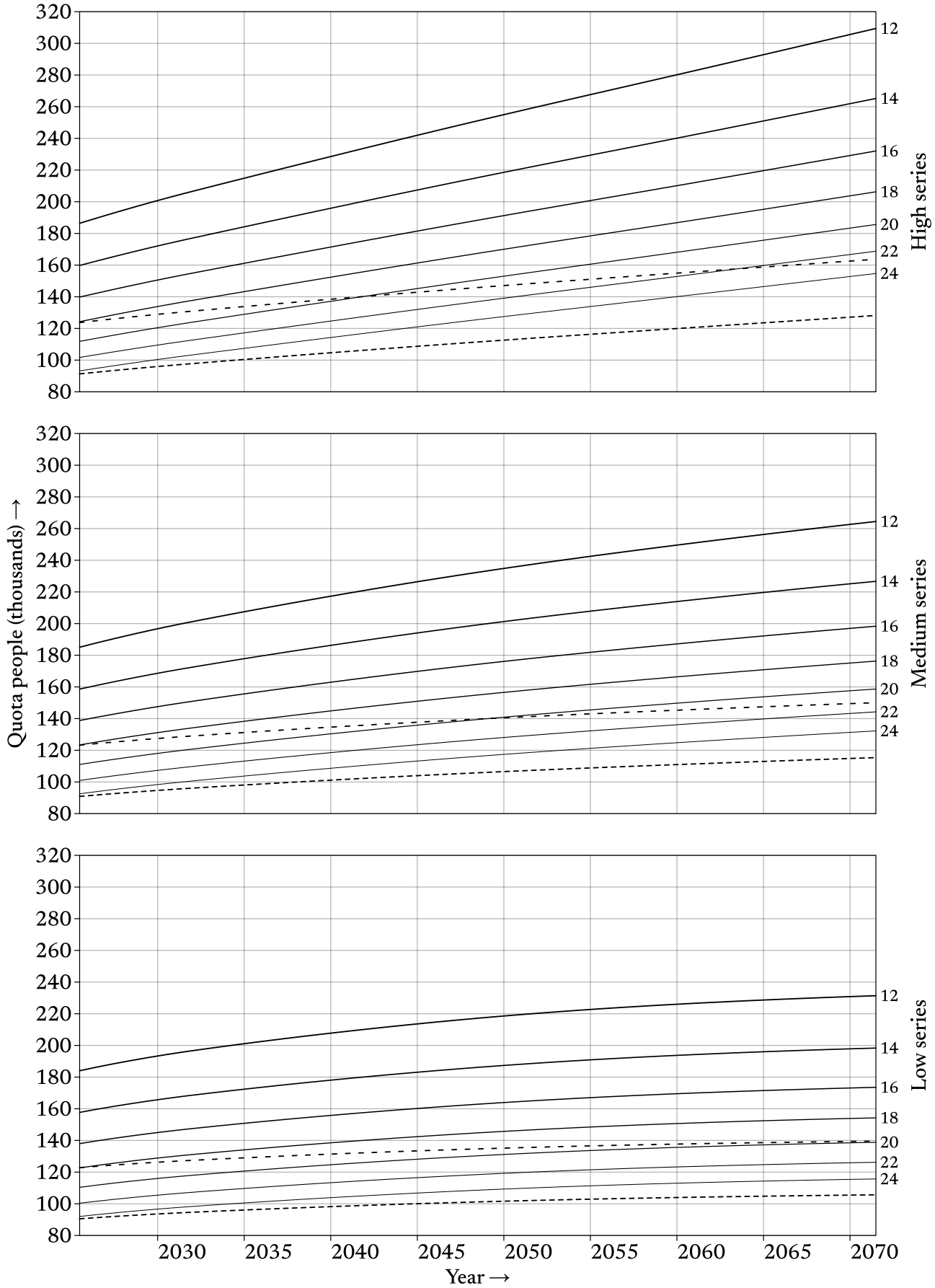

Chart 11: The value of one s24 quota, calculated for each series of the ABS' 2022-2071 long-term projections of Australia's population, and several potential Senator counts. The high series assumes higher fertility, greatly increased life expectancy and very high net migration from overseas. The low series assumes decreased fertility, mildly increased life expectancy, and higher-than-recent-average net migration.

Alas, whatever metric we pick, population growth will inevitably slip away from us. All that can really be done is to push the day further expansion is required far into the future. By that measure, I feel that 18 Senators per state is the most appropriate choice. 18 Senators per state also eliminates[21] the current minimum-of-5-Reps malapportionment that exists in the Constitution.[22] But it is also, to borrow from *The Castle*, the vibe.

A move to 14 leaves us with the same number of people per representative in about a decade, 16 in two decades, 18 we're good until at least the 2060s, and then what are we doing, adding 2 more each? Diminishing returns and all, I suspect not. Job's a good 'un.

Why not go even further, to 20 or more? Well before I answer that, I'll ask you to turn to appendix F on page 31 (that's the end of the submission) where you'll find a truly monstrous chart showing what I have calculated as the number of Representatives for each state for each number of Senators I've discussed, for every year since the last expansion in 1984. It sort of reminds me of a candy cane.

Reason to not go further, the first: Parliament House was designed to be expanded into, yes, but only so much. Beautiful though it is, the day may come that it is no longer fit for purpose. Let's try not to make that immediately, yeah?

Reason to not go further, the second, and this one's rather selfish: There's a very annoying side-effect that can be discovered if you look closely at the pages for 20 and 22 Senators per state, relating to Tasmania. Tasmania currently uses the Hare-Clark system to elect its lower house, the House of Assembly, electing seven members from each of five electorates. In order to reduce confusion[23] the Tasmanian Parliament has elected to use the Federal House of Representatives boundaries as-is.

At 20 Senators per state, we're in a precarious situation where, yes, Tasmania's population as a percentage of Australia's is dropping,[24] but still much too close to wrapping back up to 6. And at 22, we've well and truly stepped in it. What does Tasmania do if that happens? I don't want to think about it, and neither does anyone else. 24 is right out. Got it? Good.

Recommendations

1. That the *Representation Act 1983* be repealed and replaced with a Representation Act that has similar effect, except that the number of senators for each State shall be 18;
2. Assuming 1 is not adopted, the same, except that the number of senators for each State shall be 16.

The author of this submission has no opinion on the representation of territories in the Senate, except:

3. That in the event territory representation in the Senate is increased to a number less than 6 total Senators, those Senators continue to be elected for unstaggered terms of three years.

[21] For the time being, anyway.

[22] We'll circle back to this.

[23] And save a boatload of money not doing the redistributions ourselves.

[24] Circling back: This is what eventually puts House malapportionment back on the table. ☹

Pipe dream constitutional amendments

Section 44 still sucks, but appears sticky

There is little to be said about section 44 of the Australian Constitution that has not already been said by 45th Parliament's iteration of the JSCEM.[25] It is bad law and should be repealed, *but this will not happen because it would require a referendum.*

Which I'm sure some will find pessimistic, but I don't think such pessimism is unfounded. In the nearly 125 years since Federation, Australia has held 45 constitutional referenda, eight successful, but none successful since 1977. Broad support is, especially under compulsory voting, required for success.

I suspect I am not alone in my contempt for section 44. 2017 was only eight years ago, and while most of the members of this Committee were not directly affected by the eligibility crisis,[26] I'm sure the ripples have been felt by all. But the wording of s44(i) is such that any attempt to rectify it is surely open to a scare campaign, and scare campaigns sink referenda. Careful thought is required.

The term length discussion is a waste of time

Legislatively fixed terms are only as strong as the will of Parliament not to overturn the legislation or to implement a get-out-of-political-inconvenience-free card.

The UK passed the *Fixed-term Parliaments Act* in 2011, requiring that terms of the UK Parliament run for five years. While the 2015 election ran as scheduled, the scheme quickly fell apart thereafter. The FTPA provided that a two-thirds majority of the House of Commons could waive the five year requirement, and this occurred in 2017 when then Prime Minister Theresa May wanted to bolster a slim working majority.[27] And in 2019, when her successor Boris Johnson couldn't find two-thirds, legislation was swiftly passed in the usual fashion to let it happen anyway.[28] Exposed for the sham it was, the FTPA was repealed in 2022.

Canada similarly passed *An Act to Amend the Canada Elections Act* in 2007, which would have fixed term lengths at four years. But the Governor-General retained the power to dissolve Parliament at their discretion, so when a minority government fell out of favour in 2008, a year ahead of schedule, and in 2011… 2021… a few months early in 2025… I'm sure you get the picture at this point.

As long as legislation can be repealed[29] or circumvented, or a visit can be made to the Governor-General,[30] fixed terms simply aren't.[31]

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[25] https://www.aph.gov.au/Parliamentary_Business/Committees/Joint/Electoral_Matters/Inquiry_into_matters_relating_to_Section_44_of_the_Constitution/Report_1/

[26] It is only the election by countback of Senator Colbeck following the resignation and disqualification of the Honourable Stephen Parry that necessitates the use of "most of".

[27] Which didn't work.

[28] Which did.

[29] Parliament should not unduly constrain future parliaments.

[30] I'm assuming here that we still want double dissolutions.

[31] Fixed, that is.

Four-year terms, assuming they are otherwise desirable,[32] also do not seem workable to me, because any such move would require modifying the Constitution.

Even if it turns out to be feasible to put Reps terms to the people, the question remains of what to do with the Senate. Conventional wisdom suggests uncoupling elections should be avoided, so as not to fatigue the voterbase or diminish one of the houses.

Eight-year Senate terms, using the current half in-half out system, will never pass a referendum. Simply speaking, it stretches the limits of accountability too far to allow a Senator, who may not even be a member of the same party[33] at the end of their term, to continue for that long.

Four-year Senate terms, all in-all out, make for very large ballots, especially if expansion of the Parliament is a given. Obviously, this remains true in the event of a double dissolution, but I am happy for that to be an edge case rather than the norm.[34] I would not expect voter buy-in to be high.

Specifically pinning Senate terms to the times of Reps elections has been attempted four times in the 70s and 80s, and rejected all four times. This, all else aside, appears to be a dead end. Similarly, an attempt to remove the nexus in s24 failed resoundingly in 1967.

Recommendations

1. That someone much smarter than me look into what can *actually* be done about section 44 of the Constitution;
2. That no changes be attempted to sections 7(¶4), 13, 24 or 28 of the Constitution; and
3. That no attempt be made to introduce fixed terms to the House of Representatives.

[32] Which is debatable.

[33] This should not be taken as an endorsement of expelling defectors from Parliament. I think that concept is gross.

[34] This probably sounds like I'm calling out the NSW, SA and WA upper houses for their very-large at-large elections. And yes, I suppose I am. At least NSW and SA stagger their terms… But then we're right back to the eight-year term thing, and… 😐

Miscellaneous thoughts

I was informed after the count that the Kingswood booth [1487] in the division of Lindsay, NSW had accidentally had its House ballots amalgamated with those of the Jamisontown booth [1486] during transport. On the one hand, very unfortunate for this to have happened. On the other hand, very fortunate for *only* this to have happened. It is a credit to the AEC that they do their job as well as they do. Speaking of:

Recommendation

1. **Do not tarnish the perceived impartiality of the Australian Electoral Commission by saddling them with responsibility for "truth in political advertising" laws.**

I don't care if it's working for South Australia, we've got a good thing going, and it would be a huge shame to ruin it now. I suppose it's too much to just ask everyone to play nice? I'm kidding, I'm far too cynical to think that would ever work.

Guide to the appendices

Presented now, for your information, perusal and/or entertainment, are several large tables and charts that would have been far too disruptive had they been part of the main body of the text, and, as it has turned out, eclipse the size of the main body of the text.

Appendices A through C supplement the section on informal voting in House of Representatives elections. A and B are two different representations of data from the 2025 election, splitting the divisions and the states respectively by number of candidates. C compares across the last eight federal elections.

Appendix D supplements the section on early voting. Like the chart on page 11, this table is a representation of expected and actual election day attendance at in-division polling places at the 2025 election. The table, however, is broken down by state and demographic, rather than by division.

Appendices E and F supplement the section on expanding the Parliament. E is a table calculating the number of Representatives if Senator numbers were increased, based on the December 2024 population estimates, which were the most recent available figures at the table was created. Figures for March 2025 were released in mid-September.[35]

F is the fabled "candy cane" chart, showing self-calculated Representative entitlements since the 1984 expansion for Senator counts up to and including 24. Lines wrapping from top to bottom show an increase in entitlement, from bottom to top a decrease. The central line of each subchart is the exact integer quota to which the moving line is rounded. Dashed lines on the territory subcharts show when the special rounding rules are in play. I think this chart is really cool.

[35] Sort of ran out of spoons in the middle of writing and laying out this thing. For a few months. I picked it back up three days before the deadline. I do these things to myself, y'know?

A: 2025 federal election House of Representatives informality data

Page 1/4	Division	State	Formals	Informals	Rate
4 candidates	Perth	WA	99,756	2,491	2.44%
	Bean	ACT	102,700	2,670	2.53%
	Fenner	ACT	94,460	2,540	2.62%
	Maribyrnong	Vic.	111,197	3,098	2.71%
5 candidates	Clark	Tas.	67,531	1,677	2.42%
	Gellibrand	Vic.	105,202	3,538	3.25%
	Brand	WA	93,793	3,283	3.38%
	Isaacs	Vic.	108,181	3,958	3.53%
	Gippsland	Vic.	104,758	3,904	3.59%
	Sydney	NSW	107,249	4,161	3.73%
	Mitchell	NSW	109,553	6,156	5.32%
	Kingsford Smith	NSW	99,132	6,126	5.82%
	McMahon	NSW	97,835	11,581	10.58%
6 candidates	Curtin	WA	105,348	1,805	1.68%
	Canberra	ACT	93,405	2,021	2.12%
	Macnamara	Vic.	100,338	2,246	2.19%
	Tangney	WA	110,991	2,624	2.31%
	Lilley	Qld.	105,440	2,555	2.37%
	Boothby	SA	117,339	3,113	2.58%
	Wentworth	NSW	110,431	3,106	2.74%
	Cooper	Vic.	107,586	3,227	2.91%
	Franklin	Tas.	76,462	2,340	2.97%
	Pearce	WA	98,093	3,094	3.06%
	Swan	WA	98,280	3,114	3.07%
	Petrie	Qld.	116,792	3,746	3.11%
	Corio	Vic.	110,227	3,593	3.16%
	Canning	WA	100,647	3,450	3.31%
	Hotham	Vic.	106,211	3,692	3.36%
	La Trobe	Vic.	103,618	3,689	3.44%
	Capricornia	Qld.	98,658	3,547	3.47%
	Holt	Vic.	99,233	3,923	3.80%
	Fraser	Vic.	107,467	4,250	3.80%
	Longman	Qld.	121,929	4,998	3.94%
	Grayndler	NSW	110,878	4,763	4.12%
	Macquarie	NSW	109,705	4,758	4.16%
	Lingiari	NT	45,632	2,157	4.51%

Page 2/4	Division	State	Formals	Informals	Rate
6 candidates, continued	Cook	NSW	106,364	5,044	4.53%
	Braddon	Tas.	74,840	3,553	4.53%
	Cunningham	NSW	115,474	6,586	5.40%
	Barton	NSW	99,951	10,256	9.31%
7 candidates	Kooyong	Vic.	114,868	2,402	2.05%
	Griffith	Qld.	109,212	2,454	2.20%
	Chisholm	Vic.	112,696	2,747	2.38%
	Melbourne	Vic.	97,448	2,427	2.43%
	Goldstein	Vic.	115,673	3,198	2.69%
	Jagajaga	Vic.	111,099	3,288	2.87%
	Sturt	SA	117,137	4,049	3.34%
	Mayo	SA	125,182	4,603	3.55%
	Fremantle	WA	102,130	3,764	3.55%
	Bowman	Qld.	107,987	3,986	3.56%
	Flinders	Vic.	114,923	4,246	3.56%
	Bullwinkel	WA	104,664	3,867	3.56%
	Solomon	NT	60,130	2,240	3.59%
	Ballarat	Vic.	104,540	3,955	3.65%
	Adelaide	SA	114,089	4,478	3.78%
	Oxley	Qld.	104,062	4,128	3.82%
	Lalor	Vic.	99,284	4,120	3.98%
	Hasluck	WA	95,551	3,978	4.00%
	Bass	Tas.	71,594	3,031	4.06%
	Hawke	Vic.	103,817	4,431	4.09%
	Kingston	SA	112,695	4,959	4.21%
	Gorton	Vic.	113,430	5,210	4.39%
	Wide Bay	Qld.	105,058	4,908	4.46%
	Burt	WA	98,691	4,634	4.48%
	Robertson	NSW	101,463	4,876	4.59%
	Hinkler	Qld.	109,370	5,307	4.63%
	Dawson	Qld.	98,468	4,849	4.69%
	New England	NSW	114,346	5,816	4.84%
	Nicholls	Vic.	105,450	5,556	5.01%
	Shortland	NSW	108,108	6,731	5.86%
	Reid	NSW	101,217	6,426	5.97%
	Greenway	NSW	102,755	7,700	6.97%
	Macarthur	NSW	93,536	10,188	9.82%
	Blaxland	NSW	86,886	12,822	12.86%
	Fowler	NSW	92,938	15,079	13.96%

Page 3/4	Division	State	Formals	Informals	Rate
8 candidates	Ryan	Qld.	103,462	3,136	2.94%
	Brisbane	Qld.	110,745	3,645	3.19%
	Corangamite	Vic.	104,020	4,023	3.72%
	Deakin	Vic.	115,507	4,692	3.90%
	Menzies	Vic.	109,430	4,523	3.97%
	Moreton	Qld.	93,831	4,232	4.32%
	Casey	Vic.	110,563	5,089	4.40%
	Bonner	Qld.	99,106	4,597	4.43%
	Wills	Vic.	109,781	5,106	4.44%
	Warringah	NSW	114,895	5,520	4.58%
	Moore	WA	106,837	5,367	4.78%
	Dunkley	Vic.	109,174	5,559	4.85%
	Groom	Qld.	103,219	5,276	4.86%
	Herbert	Qld.	98,362	5,300	5.11%
	Forrest	WA	99,457	5,465	5.21%
	Fairfax	Qld.	111,048	6,180	5.27%
	O'Connor	WA	100,115	5,649	5.34%
	Fisher	Qld.	118,472	6,798	5.43%
	Maranoa	Qld.	97,687	5,606	5.43%
	Bradfield	NSW	112,202	6,656	5.60%
	Eden-Monaro	NSW	107,088	6,808	5.98%
	Bruce	Vic.	109,494	7,165	6.14%
	Wright	Qld.	116,880	7,655	6.15%
	Bennelong	NSW	109,812	7,196	6.15%
	Makin	SA	106,148	6,985	6.17%
	Kennedy	Qld.	97,162	6,460	6.23%
	Berowra	NSW	115,568	7,892	6.39%
	Rankin	Qld.	91,669	6,304	6.43%
	Forde	Qld.	107,528	7,440	6.47%
	Mallee	Vic.	103,707	7,540	6.78%
	Gilmore	NSW	111,053	8,225	6.90%
	Lyons	Tas.	76,832	5,715	6.92%
	Cowan	WA	96,141	7,194	6.96%
	Newcastle	NSW	108,266	8,145	7.00%
	Grey	SA	106,881	8,194	7.12%
	Scullin	Vic.	96,545	7,961	7.62%
	Dobell	NSW	103,427	8,680	7.74%
	Spence	SA	111,582	9,968	8.20%
	Hughes	NSW	98,295	9,205	8.56%
	Hume	NSW	99,467	9,729	8.91%

Page 4/4	Division	State	Formals	Informals	Rate
8 candidates, continued	Parramatta	NSW	97,190	9,556	8.95%
	Banks	NSW	98,935	10,998	10.00%
	Chifley	NSW	89,414	14,013	13.55%
9 candidates	Dickson	Qld.	105,579	4,676	4.24%
	Aston	Vic.	109,849	5,814	5.03%
	McEwen	Vic.	104,616	5,691	5.16%
	Wannon	Vic.	108,403	6,086	5.32%
	Indi	Vic.	105,761	6,279	5.60%
	Fadden	Qld.	111,398	6,793	5.75%
	Monash	Vic.	102,520	6,330	5.82%
	Hindmarsh	SA	112,471	7,624	6.35%
	Durack	WA	87,962	5,966	6.35%
	Flynn	Qld.	97,543	6,970	6.67%
	Moncrieff	Qld.	100,326	7,362	6.84%
	Mackellar	NSW	111,847	8,894	7.37%
	Hunter	NSW	111,672	9,782	8.05%
	Farrer	NSW	103,063	10,234	9.03%
	Watson	NSW	82,834	16,983	17.01%
	Werriwa	NSW	87,614	18,274	17.26%
10 candidates	Bendigo	Vic.	106,617	6,228	5.52%
	Blair	Qld.	116,953	8,219	6.57%
	Leichhardt	Qld.	94,480	7,372	7.24%
	Richmond	NSW	104,952	8,600	7.57%
	Barker	SA	108,714	8,934	7.59%
	Calare	NSW	106,267	9,271	8.02%
	Paterson	NSW	108,704	9,957	8.39%
	Lyne	NSW	109,350	10,979	9.12%
	Whitlam	NSW	109,316	11,909	9.82%
	Parkes	NSW	104,887	11,855	10.15%
	Lindsay	NSW	98,146	12,020	10.91%
11 candidates	Page	NSW	107,594	11,145	9.39%
	Cowper	NSW	107,735	11,864	9.92%
12 candidates	McPherson	Qld.	97,215	8,968	8.45%
13 candidates	Calwell	Vic.	89,831	10,657	10.61%
	Riverina	NSW	105,837	13,443	11.27%

Data derived from the AEC's results archive for the 2025 federal election: https://results.aec.gov.au/31496/Website/HouseDownloadsMenu-31496-Csv.htm

B: 2025 federal election House of Representatives informality data summarised by state/territory

Page 1/2	State	Seats	Formals	Informals	Rate
4 candidates	ACT	2	197,160	5,210	2.57%
	Vic.	1	111,197	3,098	2.71%
	WA	1	99,756	2,491	2.44%
	Total	**4**	**408,113**	**10,799**	**2.58%**
5 candidates	NSW	4	413,769	28,024	6.34%
	Tas.	1	67,531	1,677	2.42%
	Vic.	3	318,141	11,400	3.46%
	WA	1	93,793	3,283	3.38%
	Total	**9**	**893,234**	**44,384**	**4.73%**
6 candidates	ACT	1	93,405	2,021	2.12%
	NSW	6	652,803	34,513	5.02%
	NT	1	45,632	2,157	4.51%
	Qld.	4	442,819	14,846	3.24%
	SA	1	117,339	3,113	2.58%
	Tas.	2	151,302	5,893	3.75%
	Vic.	7	734,680	24,620	3.24%
	WA	5	513,359	14,087	2.67%
	Total	**27**	**2,751,339**	**101,250**	**3.55%**
7 candidates	NSW	8	801,249	69,638	8.00%
	NT	1	60,130	2,240	3.59%
	Qld.	6	634,157	25,632	3.88%
	SA	4	469,103	18,089	3.71%
	Tas.	1	71,594	3,031	4.06%
	Vic.	11	1,193,228	41,580	3.37%
	WA	4	401,036	16,243	3.89%
	Total	**35**	**3,630,497**	**176,453**	**4.64%**
8 candidates	NSW	13	1,365,612	112,623	7.62%
	Qld.	13	1,349,171	72,629	5.11%
	SA	3	324,611	25,147	7.19%
	Tas.	1	76,832	5,715	6.92%
	Vic.	9	968,221	51,658	5.07%
	WA	4	402,550	23,675	5.55%
	Total	**43**	**4,486,997**	**291,447**	**6.10%**

Page 2/2	State	Seats	Formals	Informals	Rate
9 candidates	NSW	5	497,030	64,167	11.43%
	Qld.	4	414,846	25,801	5.86%
	SA	1	112,471	7,624	6.35%
	Vic.	5	531,149	30,200	5.38%
	WA	1	87,962	5,966	6.35%
	Total	**16**	**1,643,458**	**133,758**	**7.53%**
10 candidates	NSW	7	741,622	74,591	9.14%
	Qld.	2	211,433	15,591	6.87%
	SA	1	108,714	8,934	7.59%
	Vic.	1	106,617	6,228	5.52%
	Total	**11**	**1,168,386**	**105,344**	**8.27%**
11 candidates	NSW	2	215,329	23,009	9.65%
	Total	**2**	**215,329**	**23,009**	**9.65%**
12 candidates	Qld.	1	97,215	8,968	8.45%
	Total	**1**	**97,215**	**8,968**	**8.45%**
13 candidates	NSW	1	105,837	13,443	11.27%
	Vic.	1	89,831	10,657	10.61%
	Total	**2**	**195,668**	**24,100**	**10.97%**
Any candidates	ACT	3	290,565	7,231	2.43%
	NSW	46	4,793,251	420,008	8.06%
	NT	2	105,762	4,397	3.99%
	Qld.	30	3,149,641	163,467	4.93%
	SA	10	1,132,238	62,907	5.26%
	Tas.	5	367,259	16,316	4.25%
	Vic.	38	4,053,064	179,441	4.24%
	WA	16	1,598,456	65,745	3.95%
	Total	**150**	**15,490,236**	**919,512**	**5.60%**

Data derived from the AEC's results archive for the 2025 federal election:
https://results.aec.gov.au/31496/Website/HouseDownloadsMenu-31496-Csv.htm

C: 2004-25 federal election House of Representatives informality data

	2004	2007	2010	2013	2016	2019	2022	2025	-2013	2016-	All years
3 candidates	-	-	6.38%	-	5.08%	-	-	-	6.38%	5.08%	6.17%
4 candidates	4.35%	4.25%	5.74%	-	4.14%	3.86%	-	2.58%	5.40%	3.74%	4.82%
5 candidates	4.40%	4.27%	5.02%	5.59%	4.73%	5.30%	5.50%	4.73%	4.87%	4.96%	4.92%
6 candidates	4.70%	3.51%	4.97%	5.44%	4.27%	5.34%	4.34%	3.55%	4.51%	4.47%	4.49%
7 candidates	4.89%	3.81%	5.80%	5.64%	4.92%	4.82%	4.46%	4.64%	4.97%	4.70%	4.82%
8 candidates	5.58%	3.91%	7.22%	6.50%	5.59%	5.92%	5.39%	6.10%	5.47%	5.81%	5.68%
9 candidates	5.70%	4.53%	5.70%	6.16%	6.64%	6.83%	5.60%	7.53%	5.62%	6.50%	6.09%
10 candidates	5.83%	5.00%	6.36%	5.97%	6.23%	6.45%	5.96%	8.27%	5.79%	6.74%	6.44%
11 candidates	6.83%	4.87%	8.79%	6.25%	8.25%	-	6.11%	9.65%	6.44%	7.27%	6.90%
12 candidates	7.41%	-	-	5.21%	-	-	4.70%	8.45%	5.70%	6.62%	6.04%
13 candidates	-	6.22%	-	5.91%	-	11.16%	-	10.97%	6.01%	11.03%	8.66%
14 candidates	11.83%	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	11.83%	-	11.83%
15 candidates	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
16 candidates	-	-	-	5.95%	-	-	-	-	5.95%	-	5.95%
Any candidates	5.18%	3.95%	5.55%	5.91%	5.05%	5.54%	5.19%	5.60%	5.16%	5.35%	5.27%

Data derived from the AEC's results archives for the following federal elections:

2004	https://results.aec.gov.au/12246/results/HouseDownloadsMenu-12246-Csv.htm
2007	https://results.aec.gov.au/13745/Website/HouseDownloadsMenu-13745-csv.htm
2010	https://results.aec.gov.au/15508/Website/HouseDownloadsMenu-15508-csv.htm
2013	https://results.aec.gov.au/17496/Website/HouseDownloadsMenu-17496-csv.htm
2016	https://results.aec.gov.au/20499/Website/HouseDownloadsMenu-20499-Csv.htm
2019	https://results.aec.gov.au/24310/Website/HouseDownloadsMenu-24310-Csv.htm
2022	https://results.aec.gov.au/27966/Website/HouseDownloadsMenu-27966-Csv.htm
2025	https://results.aec.gov.au/31496/Website/HouseDownloadsMenu-31496-Csv.htm

D: Expected vs Actual election day attendance at in-division polling places at the 2025 federal election

p. 1/2	Demographic	Seats	Expected	Actual	Diff.
ACT	Inner Metropolitan	3	145,108	135,713	-6.47%
	Total	**3**	**145,108**	**135,713**	**-6.47%**
NSW	Inner Metropolitan	14	775,241	751,574	-3.05%
	Outer Metropolitan	12	655,694	608,521	-7.19%
	Provincial	9	491,910	456,475	-7.20%
	Rural	11	562,641	530,368	-5.74%
	Total	**46**	**2,485,486**	**2,346,938**	**-5.57%**
NT	Inner Metropolitan	1	22,260	19,640	-11.77%
	Rural	1	10,723	8,006	-25.34%
	Total	**2**	**32,983**	**27,646**	**-16.18%**
Qld.	Inner Metropolitan	4	203,008	163,985	-19.22%
	Outer Metropolitan	9	395,672	331,187	-16.30%
	Provincial	8	362,541	290,246	-19.94%
	Rural	9	384,804	301,452	-21.66%
	Total	**30**	**1,346,025**	**1,086,870**	**-19.25%**
SA	Inner Metropolitan	3	188,211	181,842	-3.38%
	Outer Metropolitan	4	235,965	229,636	-2.68%
	Rural	3	194,059	176,125	-9.24%
	Total	**10**	**618,235**	**587,603**	**-4.95%**
Tas.	Inner Metropolitan	1	39,221	38,912	-0.79%
	Outer Metropolitan	1	46,155	43,699	-5.32%
	Provincial	1	46,159	44,081	-4.50%
	Rural	2	95,339	88,562	-7.11%
	Total	**5**	**226,874**	**215,254**	**-5.12%**
Vic.	Inner Metropolitan	11	502,872	474,127	-5.72%
	Outer Metropolitan	12	542,603	502,320	-7.42%
	Provincial	6	261,706	231,322	-11.61%
	Rural	9	425,217	377,786	-11.15%
	Total	**38**	**1,732,398**	**1,585,555**	**-8.48%**
WA	Inner Metropolitan	6	309,964	274,129	-11.56%
	Outer Metropolitan	7	320,590	283,776	-11.48%
	Rural	3	144,875	135,208	-6.67%
	Total	**16**	**775,429**	**693,113**	**-10.62%**

p. 2/2	Demographic	Seats	Expected	Actual	Diff.
Total	Inner Metropolitan	43	2,185,885	2,039,922	-6.68%
	Outer Metropolitan	45	2,196,679	1,999,139	-8.99%
	Provincial	24	1,162,316	1,022,124	-12.06%
	Rural	38	1,817,658	1,617,507	-11.01%
	Total	**150**	**7,362,538**	**6,678,692**	**-9.29%**

Data (expected attendance) derived from the AEC's expected election day polling places as at 3 May 2025: https://aec.gov.au/About_AEC/cea-notices/files/2025/prdelms.gaz.statics.250503.09.00.02.csv

Data (actual attendance) derived from individual polling places in the AEC's Media Feed archive for the 2025 federal election as at 16 June 2025: ftp://mediafeedarchive.aec.gov.au/31496/

Data (demographics) derived from the AEC's results archive for the 2025 federal election: https://results.aec.gov.au/31496/Website/HouseDownloadsMenu-31496-Csv.htm

E: Projected Representatives for increased numbers of Senators

	Population	ACT	NSW	NT	Qld.	SA	Tas.	Vic.	WA
31 Dec 2024	26,651,151		8,545,140		5,618,765	1,891,670	575,756	7,011,123	3,008,697
	27,400,013	484,179		264,683					

Data derived from the ABS' Estimated Resident Population for December 2024:
https://www.abs.gov.au/statistics/people/population/national-state-and-territory-population/dec-2024

Per State	Quota	ACT	NSW	NT	Qld.	SA	Tas.	Vic.	WA	Total
12 Senators (status quo)	185,077	2.62 3.	46.17 46.	1.43 2.	30.36 30.	10.22 10.	3.11 5.	37.88 38.	16.26 16.	148.05 150.
14 Senators (7/cycle)	158,636	3.05 3.	53.87 54.	1.67 2.	35.42 35.	11.92 12.	3.63 5.	44.20 44.	18.97 19.	172.72 174.
16 Senators (8/cycle)	138,808	3.49 3.	61.56 62.	1.91 2.	40.48 40.	13.63 14.	4.15 5.	50.51 51.	21.68 22.	197.39 199.
18 Senators (9/cycle)	123,384	3.92 4.	69.26 69.	2.15 2.	45.54 46.	15.33 15.	4.67 5.	56.82 57.	24.38 24.	222.07 222.
20 Senators (10/cycle)	111,046	4.36 4.	76.95 77.	2.38 2.	50.60 51.	17.03 17.	5.18 5.	63.14 63.	27.09 27.	246.74 246.
22 Senators (11/cycle)	100,951	4.80 5.	84.65 85.	2.62 3.	55.66 56.	18.74 19.	5.70 6.	69.45 69.	29.80 30.	271.42 273.
24 Senators (12/cycle)	92,539	5.23 5.	92.34 92.	2.86 3.	60.72 61.	20.44 20.	6.22 6.	75.76 76.	32.51 33.	296.09 296.

Further notes overleaf.

Under the CEA: the Jervis Bay Territory is included in the Australian Capital Territory; if Norfolk Island is not entitled to a Representative, it is included in the Australian Capital Territory; and if either Christmas Island or the Cocos (Keeling) Islands are not entitled to a Representative, they are included in the Northern Territory.[36]

Quotas are based on the population of the Commonwealth, or rather, the population of the states only. One quota is the population of the Commonwealth, divided by two times the total number of state Senators. There are six states, so the population of the Commonwealth is divided by twelve times the number of Senators that each state has.

Under the CEA, population is ascertained 12 months after the House of Representatives first sits. That will be 22 July 2026, and the December 2025 ERP will be the most recent available data.

Under the Constitution, all (Original) States are entitled to a minimum of 5 Representatives. Under the CEA, territory quotas are rounded up to an additional Representative from $1\frac{1}{3}$ or $2\frac{2}{5}$ instead of $1\frac{1}{2}$ or $2\frac{1}{2}$.

Under the Constitution, all (Original) States are entitled to the same number of Senators. Under the CEA, the Australian Capital Territory and the Northern Territory are each entitled to at least two Senators each, and all territories[37] are entitled to one Senator for every two Representatives.[38]

[36] All of these are, of course, vanishingly unlikely. Using the same December 2024 figures, Norfolk Island would gain a Representative if every State had 506 Senators, Christmas Island at 594, and Cocos (Keeling) Islands at 1794.

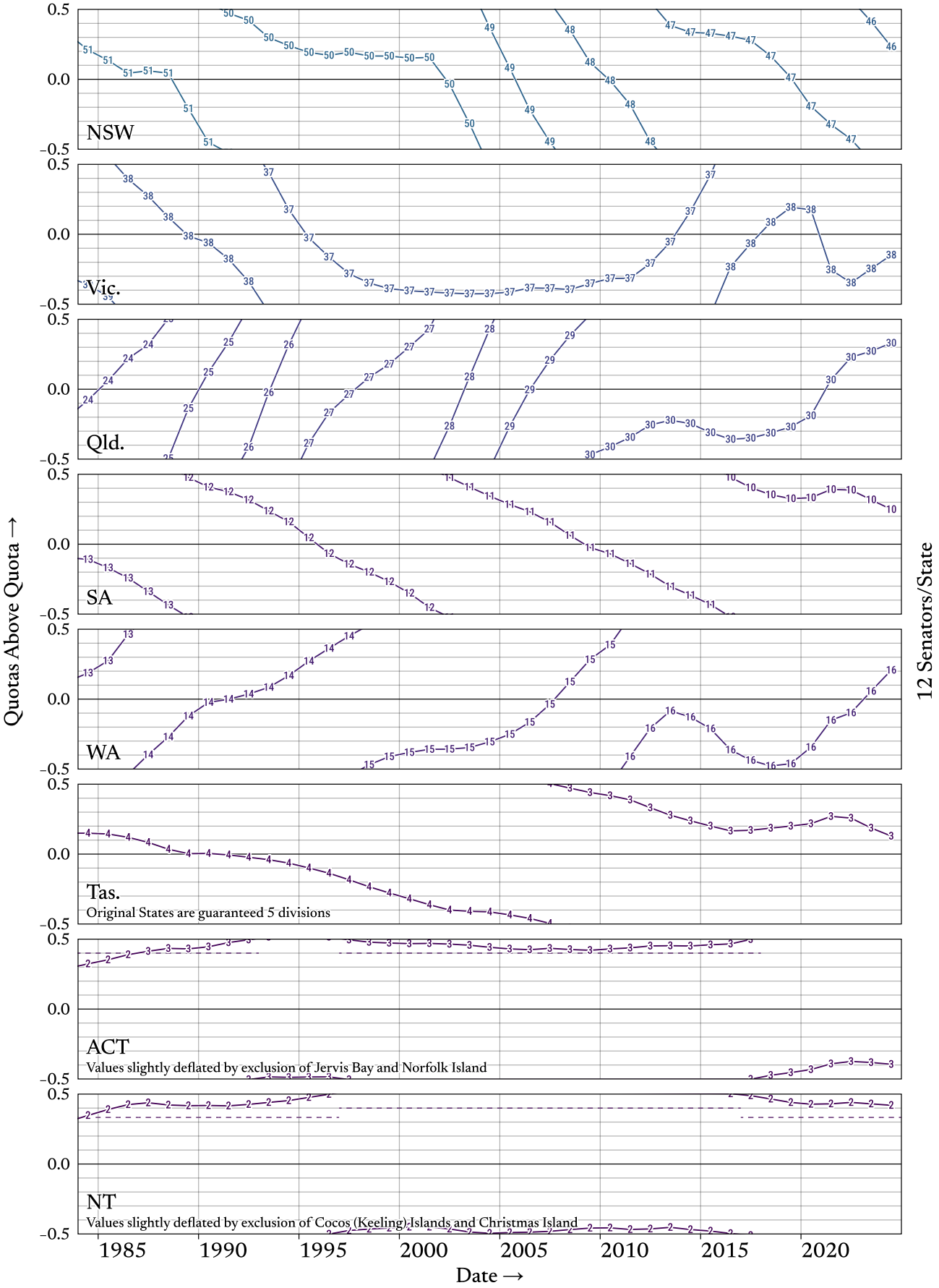
This would result in 6,242, 7,329, and 22,134 House electoral divisions, respectively, eclipsing the size of the current largest legislative body in the world, the National People's Congress of the People's Republic of China. I don't even want to think about the required construction to house such a body.

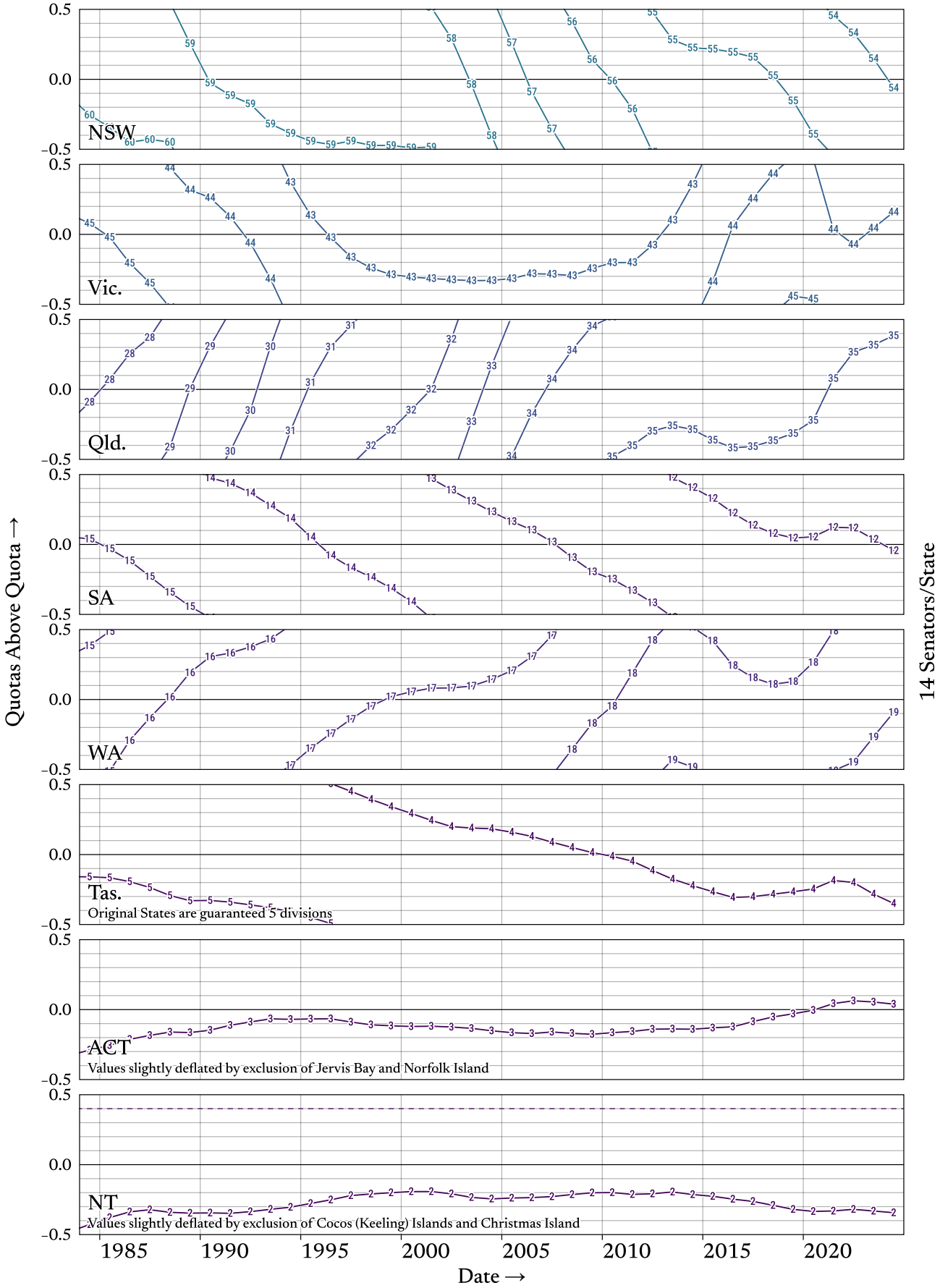
The complete calculations are available here: https://docs.google.com/spreadsheets/d/19mBMK4Ry7Pw2R5u7ZCgboLqsjOW65MKcGMgPGewJvTY/

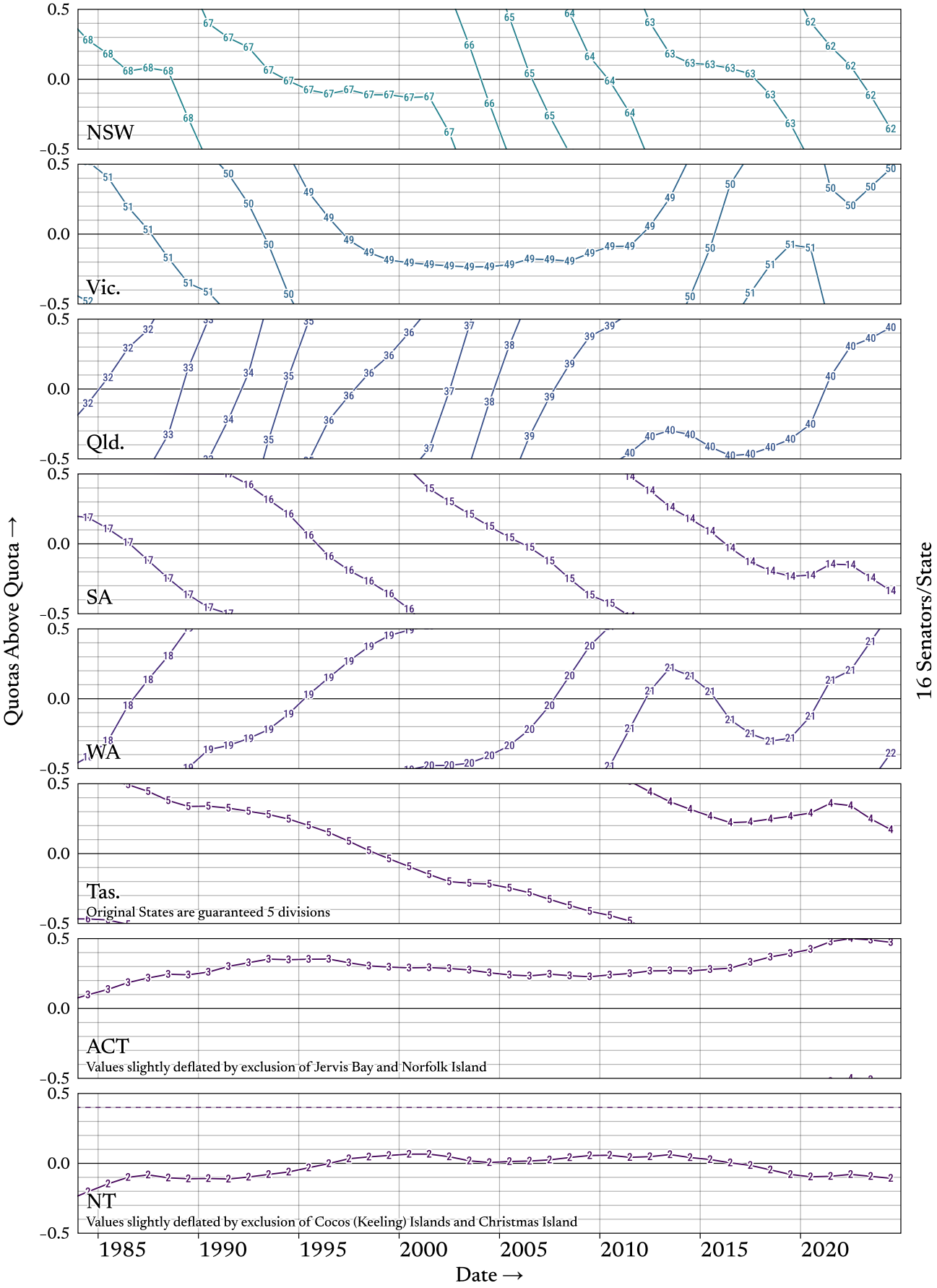
[37] We can still do worse. The Australian Antarctic Territory and the Coral Sea may not have a permanent population but they are populated nonetheless. The AAT would require several thousand Senators per state to get just one Representative, and one in every sixteen people would need to be Senators to give the four scientists on the Coral Sea Islands a Representative. (Of the remaining fifteen people, two would be Representatives.)

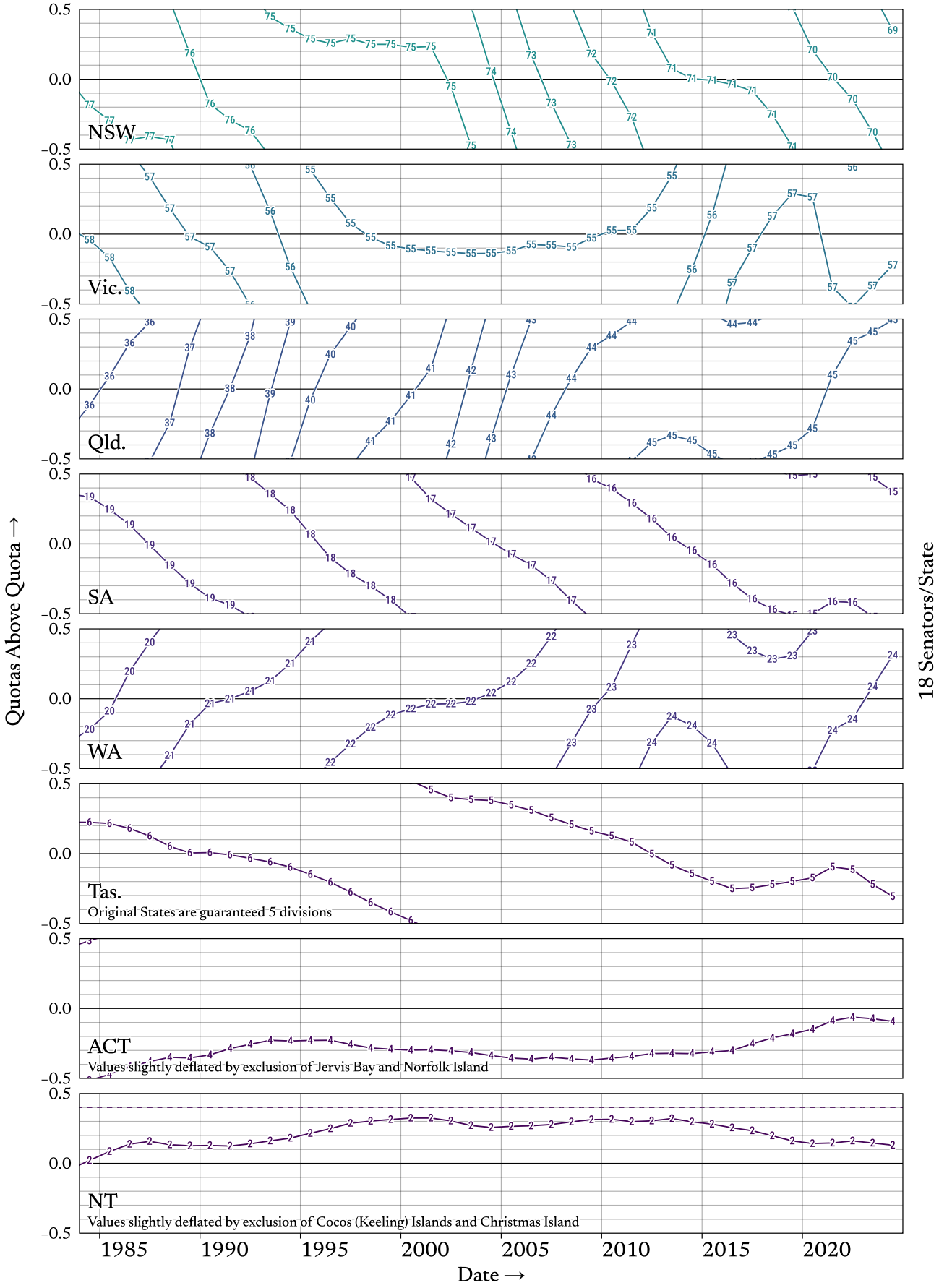
[38] Using the same December 2024 figures, the ACT would earn a third Senator if each state had 26 Senators, and the NT if each state had 48.

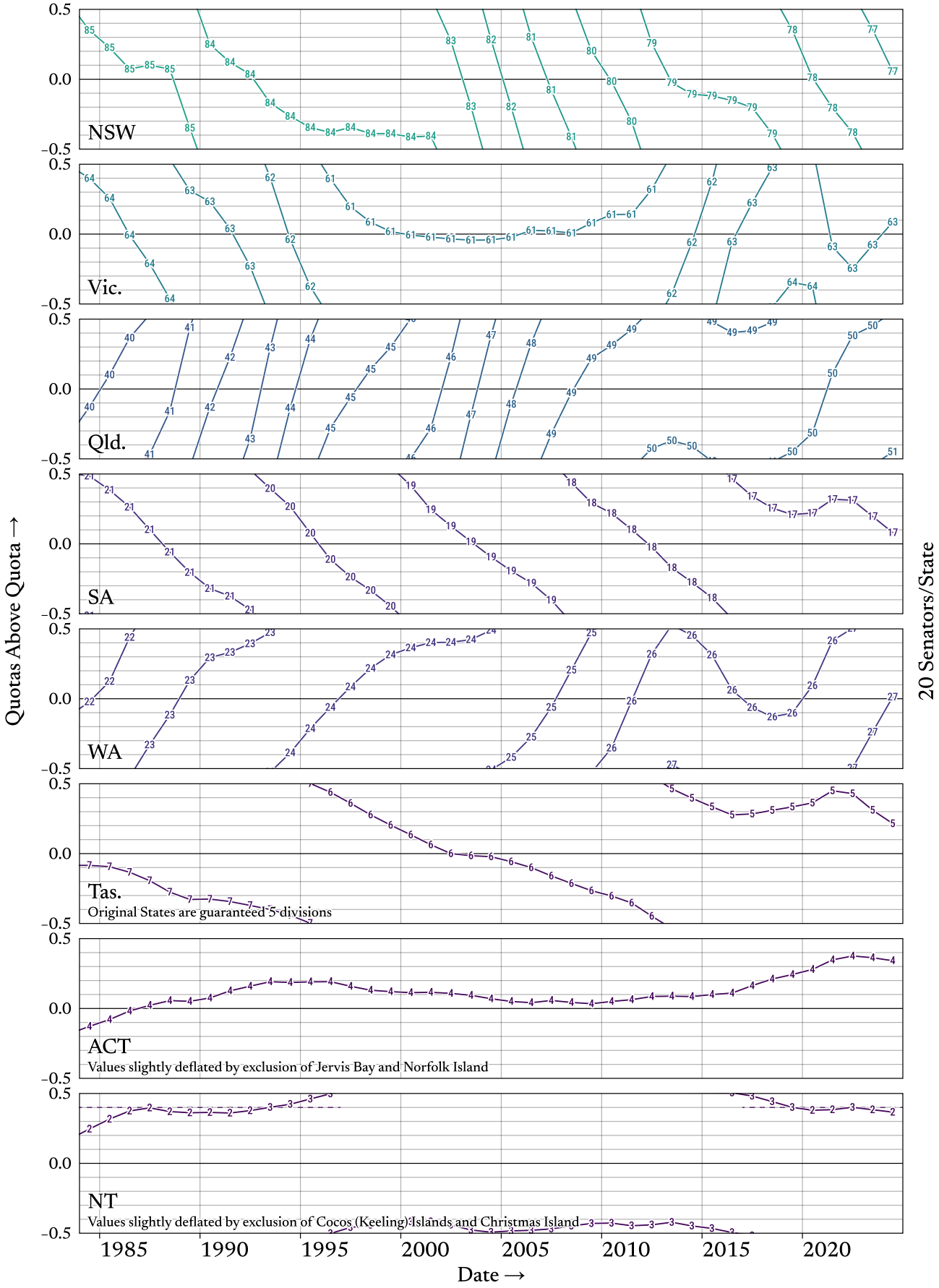
F: Projected Representatives for increased numbers of Senators, between June 1984 and June 2024

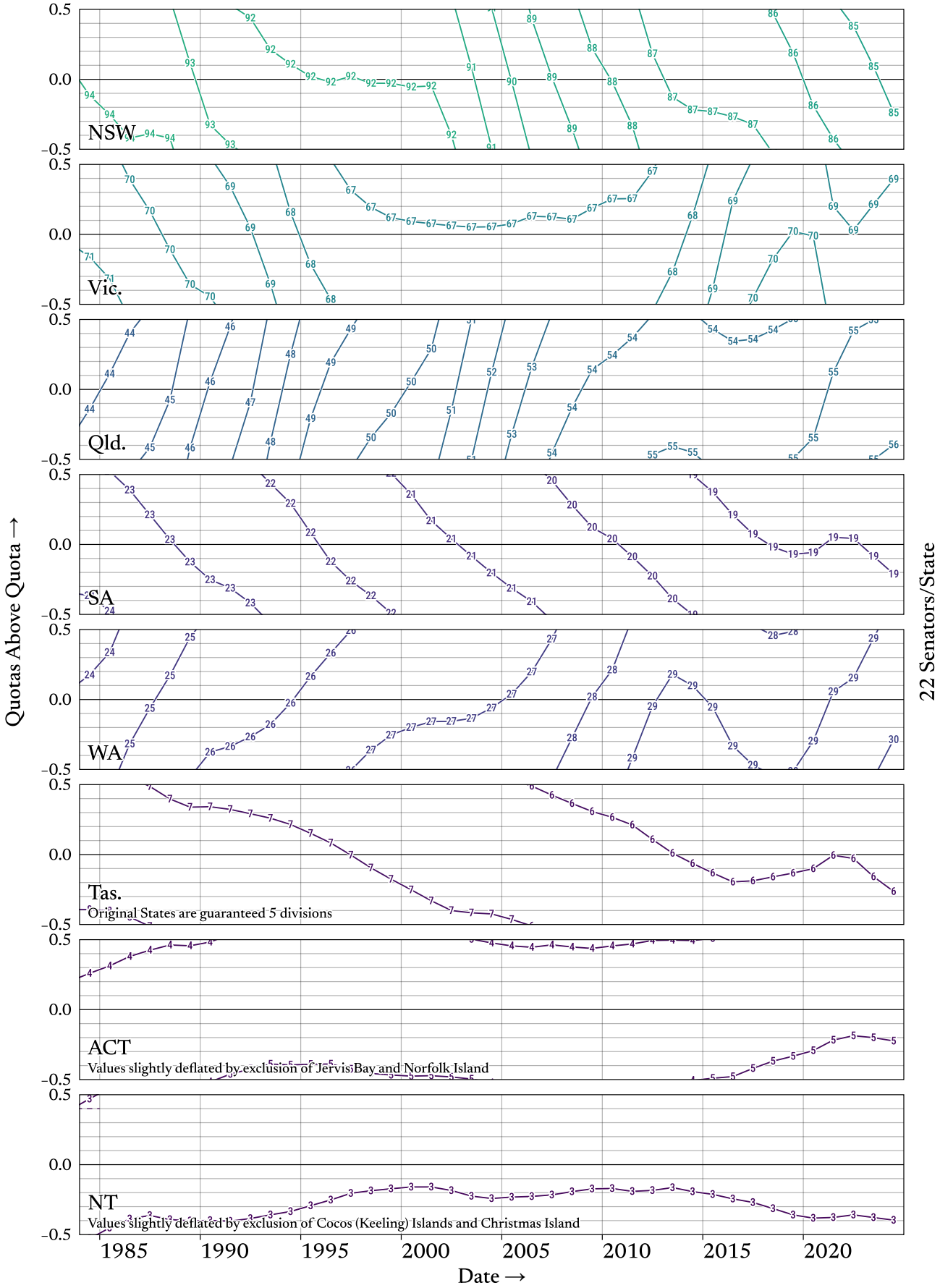


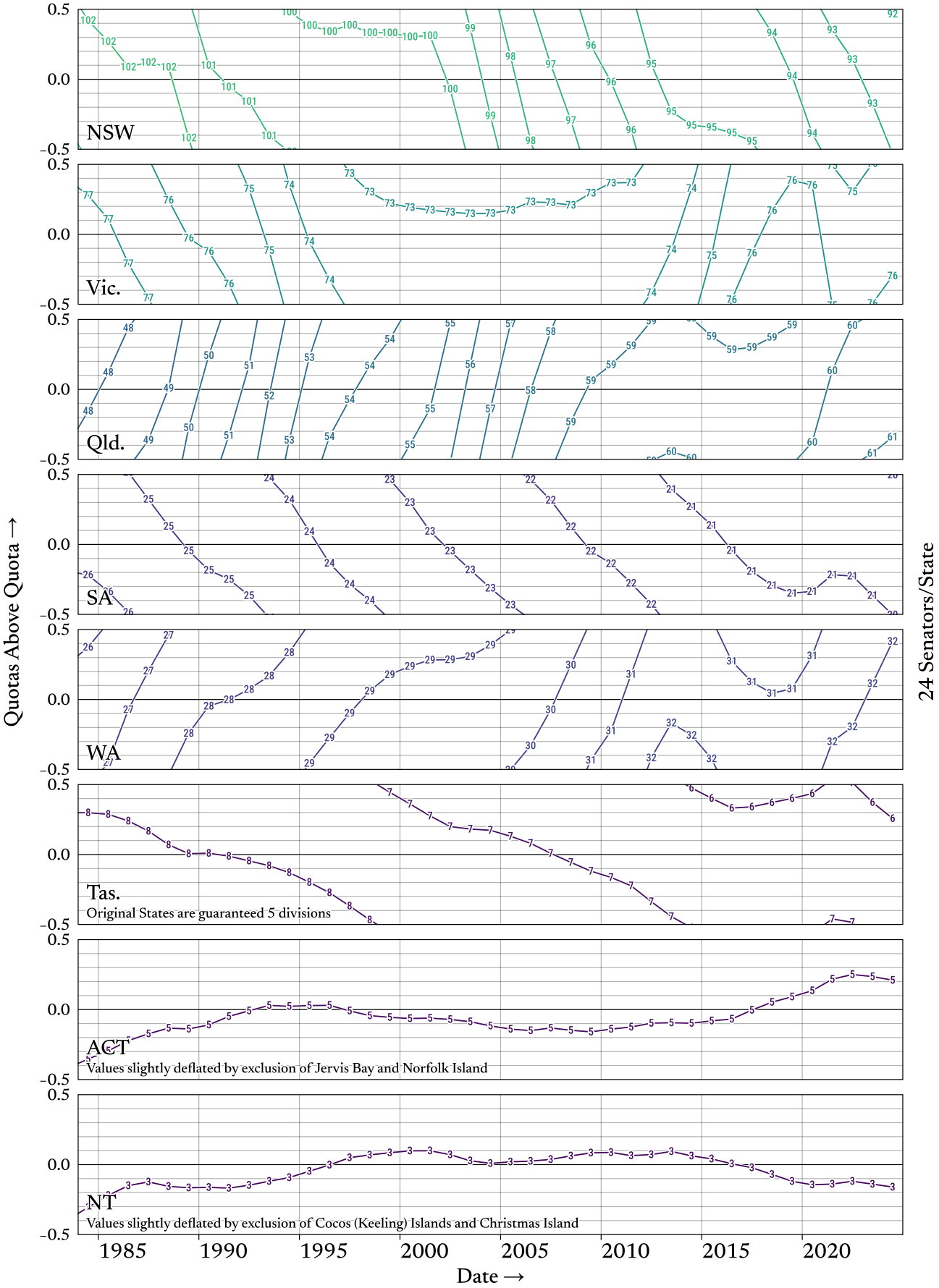

NSW
Vic.
Qld.
SA
WA
Tas.
Original States are guaranteed 5 divisions
ACT
Values slightly deflated by exclusion of Jervis Bay and Norfolk Island
NT
Values slightly deflated by exclusion of Cocos (Keeling) Islands and Christmas Island
Quotas Above Quota →
14 Senators/State
Date →
1985
1990
1995
2000
2005
2010
2015
2020


NSW
Vic.
Qld.
SA
WA
Tas.
Original States are guaranteed 5 divisions
ACT
Values slightly deflated by exclusion of Jervis Bay and Norfolk Island
NT
Values slightly deflated by exclusion of Cocos (Keeling) Islands and Christmas Island
Quotas Above Quota →
16 Senators/State
Date →
1985
1990
1995
2000
2005
2010
2015
2020


Quotas Above Quota →
18 Senators/State
NSW
Vic.
Qld.
SA
WA
Tas.
Original States are guaranteed 5 divisions
ACT
Values slightly deflated by exclusion of Jervis Bay and Norfolk Island
NT
Values slightly deflated by exclusion of Cocos (Keeling) Islands and Christmas Island
0.5
0.0
−0.5
1985
1990
1995
2000
2005
2010
2015
2020
Date →


Quotas Above Quota →
20 Senators/State
NSW
Vic.
Qld.
SA
WA
Tas.
Original States are guaranteed 5 divisions
ACT
Values slightly deflated by exclusion of Jervis Bay and Norfolk Island
NT
Values slightly deflated by exclusion of Cocos (Keeling) Islands and Christmas Island
0.5
0.0
−0.5
1985
1990
1995
2000
2005
2010
2015
2020
Date →


Quotas Above Quota →
22 Senators/State
NSW
Vic.
Qld.
SA
WA
Tas.
Original States are guaranteed 5 divisions
ACT
Values slightly deflated by exclusion of Jervis Bay and Norfolk Island
NT
Values slightly deflated by exclusion of Cocos (Keeling) Islands and Christmas Island
0.5
0.0
−0.5
1985
1990
1995
2000
2005
2010
2015
2020
Date →



Data derived from the ABS' Estimated Resident Population for 30 June of each year between 1984 and 2024:
https://www.abs.gov.au/statistics/people/population/historical-population/2021
https://www.abs.gov.au/statistics/people/population/national-state-and-territory-population/jun-2024, under *Time series spreadsheets: Population - states and territories*